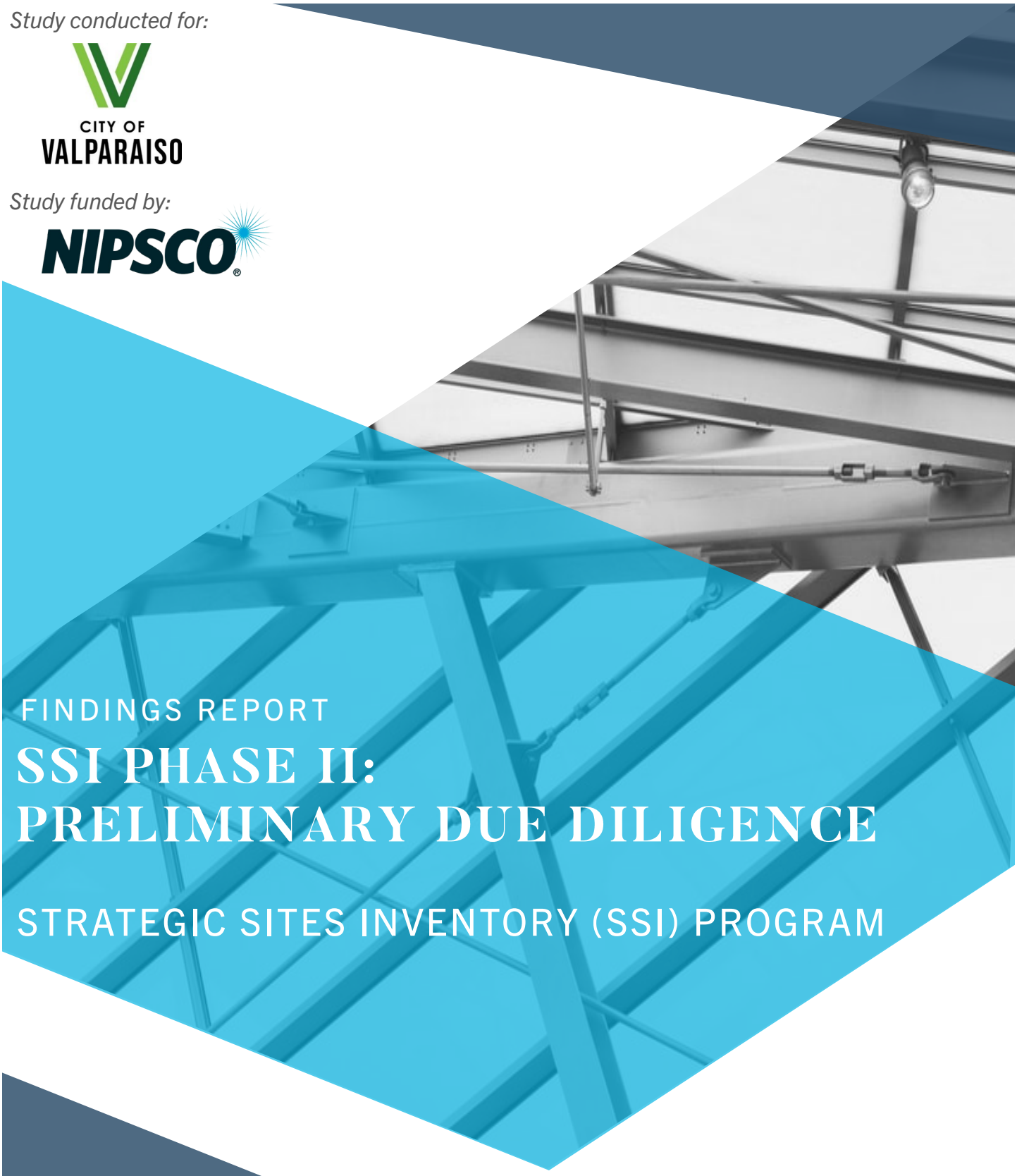
Study conducted for:

CITY OF VALPARAISO

Study funded by:

NIPSCO



FINDINGS REPORT

SSI PHASE II: PRELIMINARY DUE DILIGENCE

STRATEGIC SITES INVENTORY (SSI) PROGRAM

August 3, 2023

Site ID: 18127-020

Porter County, IN

Study conducted by:

LEOTTA LOCATION + DESIGN

Findings Report

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Park 30 East Property

Porter County, Indiana

Site ID: 18127-020

SSI QUALIFIED SITE

Size and Location

Site: 312.1 acres
Buildable Area: 217.8 acres
54 N 400 E
Valparaiso, IN 46383

Lat. 41.4428 Long. -86.9963

Current Ownership

Transpoint Intermodal LLC
Bozik James & Tabor Glenn

Highest and Best Use

Light Industrial
Manufacturing

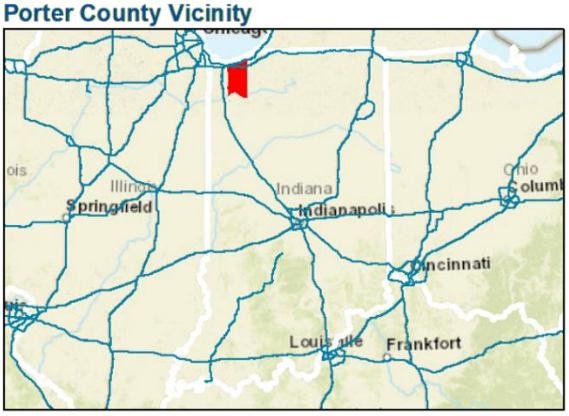
Site GPA

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Legend

- Site Location
- Rail
- Limited Access
- Major Highway
- State Highway
- Site Boundary
- Buildable Area
- County Boundary
- County Boundary

Porter County Vicinity





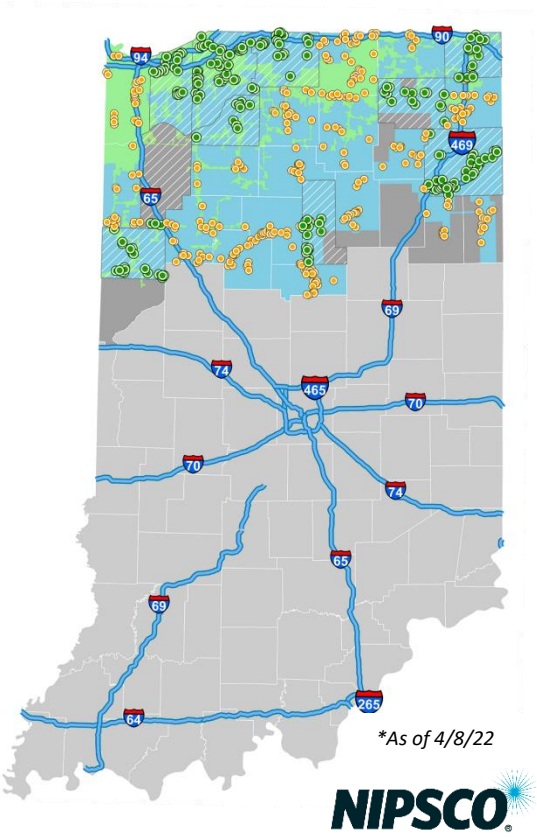


Introduction

This report presents the findings of the Strategic Sites Inventory (SSI) Phase II: Preliminary Due Diligence assessment of Site ID 18127-020 (referred to as the "Park 30 East Property"), a 312.1-acre greenfield property in the City of Valparaiso, Indiana, which is located in Porter County and serves as the county seat. The Park 30 East Property was nominated for advancement to SSI Phase II by Porter County officials and the Northern Indiana Public Service Company (NIPSCO). NIPSCO is the largest natural gas distribution company and one of the largest electric distribution companies in the state of Indiana, serving more than 821,000 natural gas customers and 468,000 electric customers across 30 counties. *The subject site satisfies baseline quality criteria, aligns with Porter County industry targets, and is deemed competitive to attract high-value business investments in support of sustainable community job growth and economic prosperity.* Report site maps are included as **Appendix A**.

SSI QUALIFIED SITE

The SSI Program is an advance site selection initiative designed to develop an inventory of strategic real estate assets to attract quality job-creating business investments. In 2019, the Indiana Economic Development Corporation (IEDC) initiated the Strategic Sites Inventory (SSI) Program in the State of Indiana with *SSI Phase I: Site Discovery* for all 92 counties with a goal to increase economic development competitiveness at the community level by identifying new, top quality raw land sites ideally suited for industrial and commercial projects. Porter County was included in the initial IEDC-funded project and benefitted from the identification of three potential high-value sites for mega site and heavy industrial land uses. A subsequent investment by IEDC in 2020 included expanded SSI Phase I site searches to identify light industrial and agribusiness sites, increasing Porter County's total of quality SSI-identified sites to twenty. A total of 554 sites have been identified within NIPSCO's served territory.



Site ID 18127-020 was identified from the expanded 2020 IEDC-funded SSI Phase I project for light industrial and agribusiness land uses, and the site boundary was later adjusted as proposed by Porter County officials. The subject site exhibits necessary competitive characteristics for SSI Phase II: Preliminary Due Diligence nomination. Details about the SSI Program phases are provided in **Appendix B**.

Leotta Location and Design (LL+D) has developed a systematic and effective methodology for screening potential sites for practical development as part of the SSI Phase II process. LL+D's site screening methodology is informed by fifteen-plus years of industrial and commercial site selection experience and economic development consulting in conjunction with demonstrated geospatial technology-based analysis and mapping expertise. LL+D staff and consulting partners include environmental science, civil and geotechnical engineering, landscape architecture, geospatial technologies, and economic devolvement experts who combine disciplines to identify and evaluate sites for industrial and commercial project uses.

The purpose of the SSI Phase II study is to provide a quantitative understanding of the subject site's advantages and challenges in conjunction with a rough order-of-magnitude (ROM) cost estimate to improve site functional use and mitigate development challenges. The SSI Phase II study is a desktop-based preliminary engineering and environmental due diligence exercise performed by discipline-specific experts with experience in industrial and commercial site selection and property development. Study of the subject site's physical and surrounding characteristics, assets, and impediments for development are reviewed in sufficient detail to formulate a defendable opinion on the competitive strength of the property for an economic development use.

The SSI Phase II study is intended to expose any potential "fatal flaws" that indicate significant development incumbrances or grossly compromise site competitiveness. The desktop review relies on an array of engineering, environmental, ecological, and cultural GIS data in conjunction with aerial imagery and available public records to assess current site development advantages and challenges. The SSI Phase II assessment concludes with the formulation of ROM cost estimates for improving site functional use and mitigating any potential development challenges.

LL+D's team of site selection and economic development experts provided an in-depth study of the subject site through an objective measure of physical features and surrounding characteristics and conditions across engineering, environmental, ecological, and cultural concerns. Overall site competitiveness for an economic development land use is made within the context of location requirements for permitting, construction, and operations relevant to the intended site project land use.

The SSI Phase II findings are expressed along three principal site assessment parameters:

Condition of the site's physical characteristics including assessment of engineering and environmental development advantages and challenges.

Connection to transportation assets, utility infrastructure, and major market areas.

Community support including available workforce, cultural feature impacts, and business climate for economic development.

A description of the subject site and summary of SSI Phase II findings is provided below.

Site Description

The Park 30 East Property is an undeveloped (greenfield) property approximately 312.1 acres in total size located along US Highway 30 (US-30) in the City of Valparaiso, Indiana. The subject site is comprised of nine tax parcels, or tracts, independently owned by two landowners of record. **Appendix C** provides a summary of site parcel ownership information.



Site ID 18127-020 north view from E Division Rd.

The current site condition is characterized by mostly farmed agricultural land and densely wooded space. A canal exists on the eastern side of the site. The property has historically been used for agriculture. A single structure meeting the description of a small warehouse owned by Transpoint Intermodal is currently observed onsite. Land use surrounding the site is a combination of agricultural, residential, commercial, and industrial. Agricultural land exists to the north, south, and east. Commercial activity is present to the north and east, while residential land use is located to the north, south, and east. Directly west of the site is an industrial park that features manufacturing facilities, warehousing and distribution, and a paper mill. Just northwest of the site across US-30 in less than 0.5 miles is the Porter County Regional Airport. The cultural setting is urban to the northwest and rural in all other directions. The site is bordered by US-30 and CFE short line railroad to the north, N 325 E to the west, N 450 E to the east, and Norfolk Southern main line railroad to the south. The Cain Ditch runs along the site's eastern boundary. *A contiguous "buildable area" was defined within the confines of the subject site boundary intended to be most advantageous for construction. The Park 30 East Property buildable area is approximately 217.8 acres and encompasses the majority of total site acreage. A buffer area surrounding the ditch near the eastern site boundary and an area across the railroad at the site's southern boundary were left out of the potential buildable area. These portions were excluded because they contain lower elevation and associated hydric soils that may be prohibitive to site development, as well as to provide buffer to nearby residential properties.*

Geographic Location

Located in northwest Indiana, Porter County provides a mix of urban and rural settings among the high-commercial activity Indiana Toll Road (I-80/90) and Interstate 94 (I-94), with access to major markets throughout the state as well as proximity to Chicago, IL. Porter County is the tenth most populous county in Indiana and contains the City of Valparaiso, which ranks thirtieth among Indiana cities by population. *In direct linear measure, the site is situated approximately 38 miles southwest of South Bend, IN; 31 miles southeast of Chicago, IL; 95 miles northwest of Fort Wayne, IN; and 111 miles northwest of Indianapolis, IN.* Projects considering the Park 30 East Property will benefit from locating on the outskirts of an urban community that is strongly embedded in economic growth and prosperity amongst a primary network of connectivity, while avoiding the heavy traffic congestion and higher land costs typical of more highly

populated metropolitan areas. Access to surrounding labor markets at competitive wage rates is well within reach of the subject site.



Site ID 18127-020 Site Vicinity

The subject site is located in the City of Valparaiso, Indiana. Valparaiso has a 2021 estimated population of 34,428 and serves as the county seat for Porter County, which has a 2021 estimated population of 174,243. The county is part of the Northwest Indiana region of the Chicago metropolitan statistical area (MSA), which has a 2020 population of 9,618,502. *More than 708,625 total residential population live within a 45-minute drive of the site. Approximately 46,587 businesses employing 695,129 people are located within a 60-minute travel time*. Construction, manufacturing, and professional, scientific, & technical services account for 17.9% of businesses employing 23.1% of total workforce within a 60-minute drive time of the site. A site vicinity map is provided in **Appendix A**.

Current Ownership

The subject site is comprised of nine contiguous tax parcels, or tracts, and is reported to have two owners. *According to Porter County officials and the county open data map, the current owners of record are Transpoint Intermodal LLC and Bozik James S & Tabor Glenn J Co-Trustees. The subject site is comprised of nine tracts of approximately 132.0, 18.7, 13.9, 3.5, 9.1, 27.9, 60.8, 7.7, and 28.9 acres according to Esri GIS data.* Porter County economic development officials have confirmed that the landowner is actively promoting the site for sale. As of the date of this report, no known real estate purchase option agreement is held with any person or organization with the landowner for any portion of the site. *LL+D strongly recommends that Porter County pursue and secure a real estate purchase option agreement with the landowner. This is critically important to reduce uncertainty regarding property availability and price*. A "Site Parcel Configuration" map is included in **Appendix A**.

Findings Summary

The findings from the SSI Phase II study are summarized below. A discussion of key site development considerations is provided within the context of overall site physical **condition**, **connection** to infrastructure, and **community** support. LL+D's site competitiveness assessment across these key site development parameters are presented below.

Condition

Site conditions are defined as the physical characteristics of the subject property including geometric configuration, surface features, engineering, ecological and environmental concerns, and land use compatibility. *Overall, conditions for the Park 30 East Property are favorable for development for the site's highest and best use as an economic development real estate asset*.

Size and Configuration of the subject site is sufficient in both acreage and configuration to support a Light Industrial or Manufacturing operation. *Total site area is approximately 312.1 acres, measuring approximately 3,982 feet across an east-west axis at its widest point and approximately 3,655 feet across a north-south axis*. The site is geometrically regular in configuration with adequate land between site boundaries providing ample acreage for a contiguous buildable area. The site has one skinny strip of land to the northwest that breaks away from the main square shaped PAD. The northern site boundary is bordered by rail and U.S. Highway 30 (US-30). Roads N 325 E and N 400 E run perpendicular to US-30 and cross the railroad to provide site access. US-30 provides the site with an adequate route for truck traffic.

A contiguous buildable area totaling 217.8 acres has been defined to optimize facility construction on the site by positioning an operational footprint to avoid wet areas and a church/residential buffer zone. The buildable area occupies the majority of the site and is comprised of nine tracts. Site access is supported by two potential ingress/egress points along N 325 E at the site's northwest corner and N 400 E near the center of the site. Both roads cross railroad at the site's northern boundary for direct access to US-30.

Hydrography and Flood Risk were evaluated by consulting USGS National Hydrography Dataset (NHD), a geospatial database which identifies stream segments or reaches that make up the nation's surface water drainage system, and FEMA National Flood Hazard Layer (NFHL), a geospatial database that contains current effective flood hazard data. *Based on a review of NHD and NFHL data, the site and buildable area are highly favorable for site development with low flood risk and minimal recorded/observed significant hydrography features. 100% of the site is outside the FEMA-designated flood hazard area and is designated as Flood Zone X (within 0.2-percent-annual-chance flood or 500-year floodplain). Drainage ditches are found along the site's eastern, northwestern, and southwestern boundaries. These features are located outside of the buildable area and should not pose any significant challenges for future project construction. Existing canals may be able to provide passive locations for site buildable area drainage and stormwater retention.* A hydrography and FEMA flood hazard map is provided in **Appendix A**.

Potential Wetlands are interpolated through observation of multiple data inputs including:

1) USGS National Wetlands Inventory (NWI) – developed for non-404 jurisdictional wetland mapping, so must be understood to have limited accuracy
2) LiDAR-derived digital elevation model (DEM) – topography/elevation
3) USGS NHD – hydrography
4) NRCS SSURGO – soils data provides hydric rating

5) Color-infrared imagery (where available) – for visual indication of wet or inundated areas (consulting differing years to ensure wet areas are not the result of a period flood event)

The NWI data is consulted as the principal indicator of potential wetlands, as the mapping methodology utilizes the above-referenced inputs in addition to other data sources in conjunction with qualified scientific review and quality control of interpolated wetlands delineation and taxonomy. The NWI data also provides a delineation of wetland types, which is important in the estimation of permitting burden and potential compensatory mitigation costs. Additional data sources are consulted to ensure congruency of information suggestive of potential wetlands occurrence.

From the US EPA Wetland Regulatory Authority fact sheet, wetlands subject to Clean Water Act Section 404 are defined as "areas that are inundated or saturated by surface or ground water at a frequency and duration sufficient to support, and that under normal circumstances do support, a prevalence of vegetation typically adapted for life in saturated soil conditions. Wetlands generally include swamps, marshes, bogs, and similar areas." There are three primary conditions required for surface areas to be considered wetlands: 1) at least periodically, the land supports predominantly hydrophytes, 2) the substrate is predominantly undrained hydric soil, and 3) the substrate is saturated with water or covered by shallow water at some time during the growing season of each year. As determined by the U.S. Army Corps of Engineers, the federal agency responsible for enforcing federal laws protecting wetlands, an area must exhibit all three of the above-referenced conditions to be considered a wetland.

The following GIS-based information was consulted for the desktop wetlands assessment:

- **Hydrophytic Vegetation**: Recent and historical aerial imagery and NWI data.
- **Wetland Hydrology**: LiDAR-derived DEM, USGS topo maps, and high-resolution aerial imagery.
- **Hydric Soils**: NRCS Web Soil Survey and SSURGO data.

There are approximately 4.06 acres of potential wetlands reported on the subject site. The wetland areas are located along the eastern, northwestern, and southwestern boundaries of the site and classified as "riverine" wetlands. Riverine wetlands depend on the flow of water conveyed by natural or artificial channels, including rivers, streams, ditches, and canals. They can form on floodplains, river terraces, and along channel beds, especially where the flows are seasonal or episodic. These wetlands play a critical role in absorbing runoff water and then slowly releasing it before it reaches rivers and streams, thus reducing downstream flooding. *According to the SSURGO Hydrologic Soil Group map, 33.4% of the total site has soils estimated to have hydric components. These soils are almost completely outside of the proposed buildable area and are located on the eastern, northwestern, and southwestern portions of the site near the potential wetland areas. While no potential wetlands are reported within the buildable area, wetland permitting and mitigation may be required on the subject site. This appears to pose minimal development impediments to the site*. NWI potential wetlands map is provided as **Appendix A**.

Soils conditions are assessed to identify potential advantages and/or challenges that could have an impact on site design, construction, and overall use of the site. Soil types are evaluated with respect to drainage and engineering performance for excavations, road construction, and building foundation support. Additionally, hydric soil ratings are used in conjunction with wetlands data to increase confidence in potential wetlands interpretation (reported in previous section).

According to the United States Department of Agriculture (USDA), Natural Resource Conservation Service (NRCS) Soil Survey Geographic Database (SSURGO) accessed via the NRCS Web Soil Survey, *33.4% (101 acres) of the subject site soils are classified as "Tracy sandy loam, 2 to 6 percent slopes" with a drainage class of "Well drained." An additional 30.8% (93.1 acres) of the site has a rating of "well drained" with various types of Tracy sand loam, Lydick loam, Door loam and Elston loam soils. Somewhat poorly drained to very poorly drained soil types including Adrian muck, Alida loam, Bourbon sandy loam, Gilford sandy loam, Sebewa loam, and Washtenaw silt loam soils make up the remaining 35.8% (108.4 acres) of the site.* These soils are assigned to SSURGO hydrologic soil groups and have slow infiltration rates with high runoff potential.

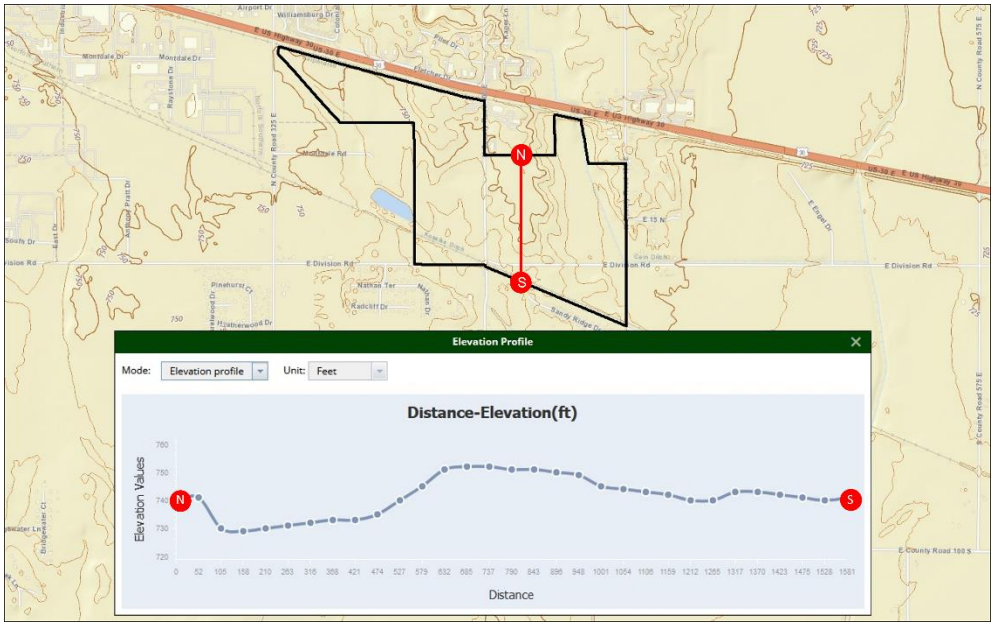
Soil suitability properties for small commercial building construction across 59.8% (180.8 acres) of the subject site are indicated as "Not limited" for shallow (2 feet deep) reinforced concrete spread footings. "Not limited" indicates that the soil has features that are very favorable for the specified use. In addition, 8.8% (26.7 acres) of the site is indicated as "Somewhat limited" for shallow (2 feet deep) reinforced concrete footings. "Somewhat limited" indicates that the soil has features that are moderately favorable for the specified use. The limitations can be overcome or minimized by special planning, design, or installation. Fair performance and moderate maintenance can be expected. The remaining 31.4% (95 acres) of the subject site is indicated as "Very limited" for shallow (2 feet deep) reinforced concrete footings. "Very limited" indicates that the soil has one or more features that are unfavorable for the specified use. The limitations generally cannot be overcome without major soil reclamation, special design, or expensive installation procedures. Poor performance and high maintenance can be expected.



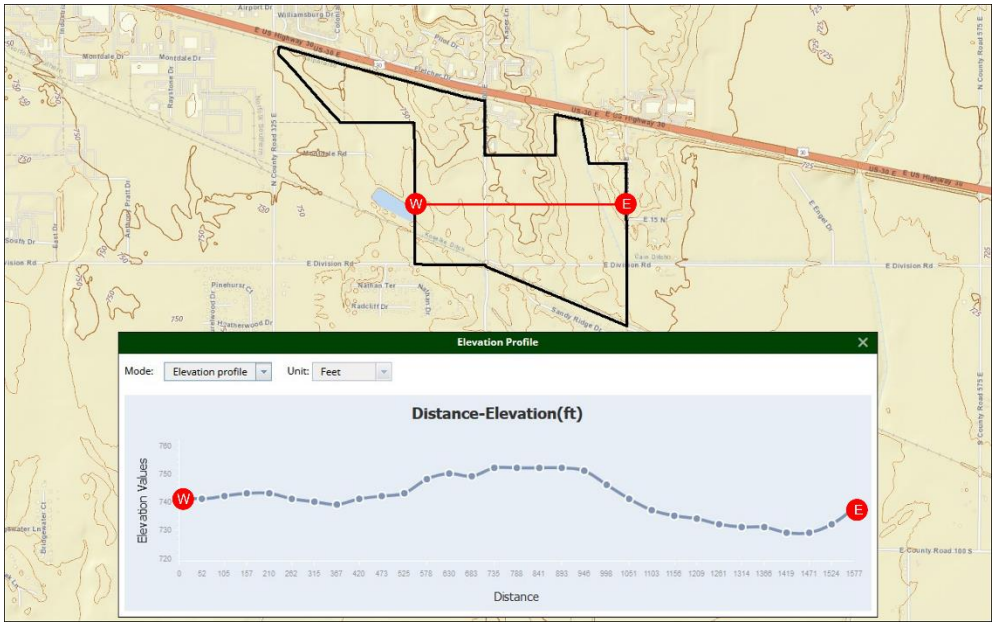
SSURGO Small Commercial Building Rating: "Not Limited"

The majority of the buildable area has soils that are very favorable for an industrial project land use. Good performance and very low maintenance can be expected. The onsite areas that contain soils with poor drainage class, hydric soils group, and limited small commercial building construction rating are primarily located outside of the buildable area on the easternmost portion of the site and along the site's northwestern and southwestern boundaries. A SSURGO soils map is provided in **Appendix A**. The USDA, NRCR SSURGO soils reports for drainage class, small commercial buildings, and hydric rating are provided in **Appendix G**.

Elevation/Topography presents minor grading challenges to prepare the site for development. *Based on a review of 5-meter cell size, LiDAR-derived digital elevation models (DEM) for the full site extent, a minimum elevation of 724 feet mean sea level (MSL) and maximum elevation of 764 feet MSL is reported. The 2021-2022 DEM indicates an average buildable area elevation of 743 feet MSL and average slope of 0.7 percent*.



18127-020 Elevation Profile North-South (USGS 3DEP Viewer)



18127-020 Elevation Profile West-East (USGS 3DEP Viewer)

The majority of the site is generally flat and without significant sloping. The lowest elevation occurs along the easternmost portion of the site, just outside of the buildable area. With the flat topography, there are not likely many cut-fill opportunities for use of onsite fill for grading/leveling. This analysis is subject to an onsite geotechnical engineering investigation to determine suitability of soil properties for construction. Additionally, any areas of naturally occurring sloping topography may provide passive locations for site buildable area drainage and stormwater retention. A LiDAR-derived DEM and 10-ft contour map is provided as **Appendix A**.

Land Cover assessment is useful for identifying site design constraints and/or potential encumbrances that may be encountered during site development such as extensive clearing and grubbing, drainage concerns, etc. The vegetative cover type is used in conjunction with soil types, elevation, and hydrography data for interpretation of environmentally sensitive conditions such as wetlands and potential habitat for Threatened and Endangered (T&E) species and other species of concern (discussed later in this report). Certain land cover features may reveal commercial value of forested areas or be desirable to incorporate into the site design. Features such as densely wooded areas may provide a desirable buffer during construction and/or during facility operations for line of sight and noise control. Another example is integrating wetland areas into site plans, thus providing an element of design aesthetics.

Two primary sources were used to assess land cover characteristics:

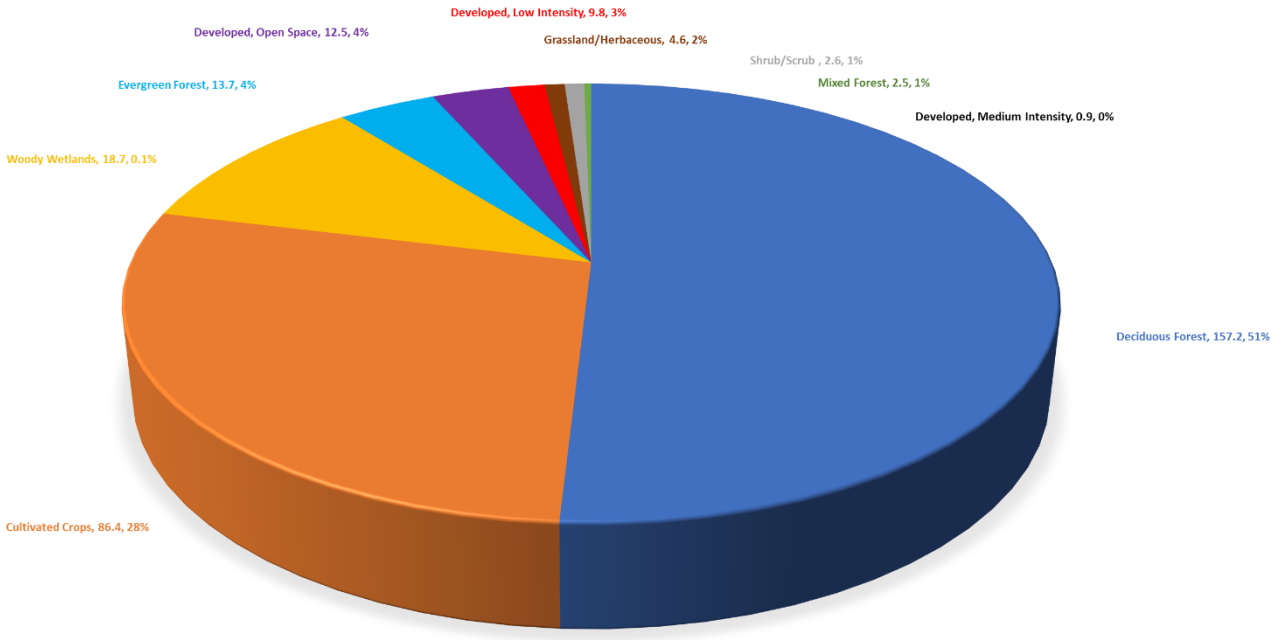
1) *Recent high-resolution color aerial imagery* (ESRI/Google Earth 2022). Recent and past aerial imagery provide useful observational data for assessing current land cover conditions, as well as any notable changes over time. However, aerial imagery alone cannot be used without additional data sources to provide a more specific delineation of land cover type. For example, densely wooded areas are readily observed from aerial imagery, however, determination of forest composition is largely indeterminate without other remotely sensed inputs (i.e., color infrared imagery) or ground-based observation.

2) *The Multi-Resolution Land Characteristics Consortium (MRLC), National Land Cover Database (NLCD)*. The National Land Cover Database (NLCD) provides nationwide data on land cover and land cover change at a 30m resolution with a 16-class legend based on a modified Anderson Level II classification system. NLCD 2019 represents the latest evolution of NLCD land cover products focused on providing innovative land cover and land cover change data for the Nation. NLCD 2019 offers 8 integrated epochs of land cover for years 2001, 2004, 2006, 2008, 2011, 2013, 2016, and 2019. Developed classes in these years are directly derived from percent developed impervious surface and include a descriptor label that identifies the type of each impervious surface pixel. The NLCD Land Cover change index combines information from all years of land cover change and provides a simple and comprehensive way to visualize change from all 8 dates of land cover in a single layer.

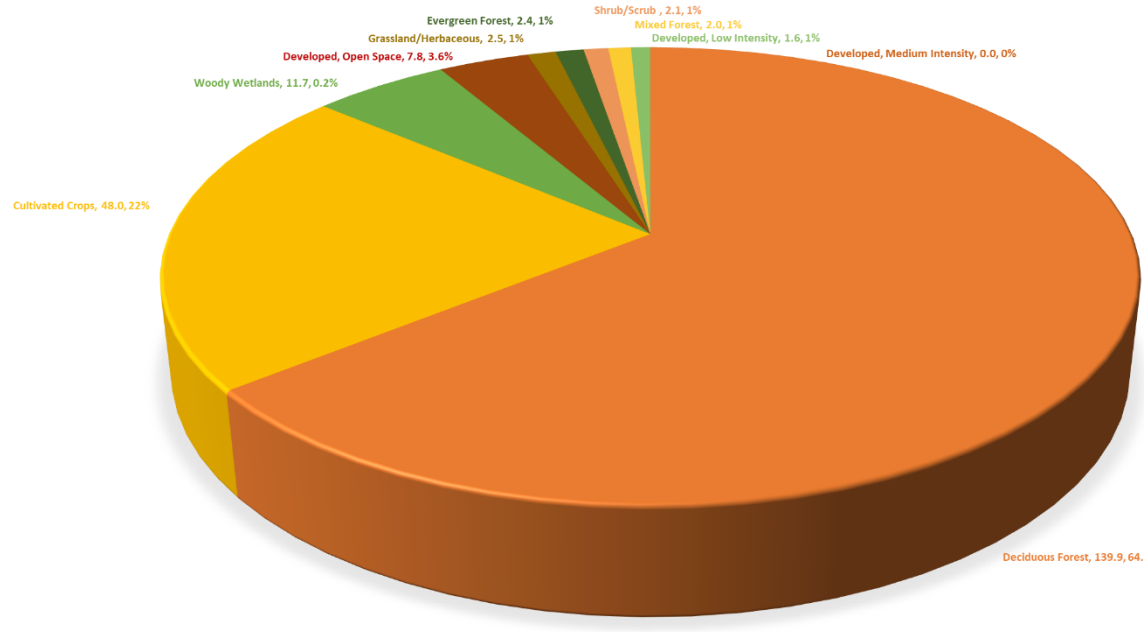
Based on a review of the MRLC NLCD dataset, land cover for the site and buildable area consists of the following classified areas (acres, percent cover):

A Land cover map is provided in **Appendix A**.

Land Cover – Site (acres, %)



Land Cover – Buildable Area (acres, %)



Sinkholes are common geological phenomenon occurring throughout the United States. They are only one of many kinds of karst landforms, which include caves, disappearing streams, springs, and underground drainage systems. Karst is a generic term which refers to the characteristic terrain produced by erosional processes associated with the chemical weathering and dissolution of limestone or dolomite.

The Sinkhole Areas and Sinking-Stream Basins Map developed by the Indiana Geological Survey shows the locations of sinkhole areas (SHA) and sinking-stream basins (SSB) in southern Indiana. Some sinkholes may exist outside the delineated areas, and some sinkholes may exist within the areas designated as sinking-stream basins, but such areas are not shown in this map. *The subject site lies entirely outside of the SHA and SSB areas, and thus should not be at risk of sinkholes.* The reliability of reported sinkhole occurrences is unknown. Potential site susceptibility to sinkholes must be determined through more thorough professional geological and geotechnical engineering investigation.

Zoning and Land Use is administered and governed by the 2009 City of Valparaiso Unified Development Ordinance. *According to SSI Pre-Project Questionnaire, the site is currently zoned Heavy Industrial. The City of Valparaiso online zoning map shows the majority of the site as being zoned "INH" Heavy Industrial, with a single tract south of the Norfolk Southern rail line at the site's southern boundary being zoned "INL" Light Industrial.* City and County Zoning Maps are provided in **Appendix D.**

The apparent current land use of the subject site is derived from the SSI Pre-Project Questionnaire, the Porter County GIS portal, recent aerial imagery, and Google Street View. *Recent aerial imagery shows current land use to be agricultural/vacant land for portions of the site containing minimal forested areas and lack of commercial structures, as well as undeveloped open space for portions of the site containing densely wooded areas. Current conditions also show that the area along the site's eastern boundary contains a drainage canal. The aerial imagery-derived land use observations for the site agree with the 2009 City of Valparaiso Unified Development Ordinance's Heavy Industrial/Light Industrial designation. It also matches with the NLC Database – Cultivated Crops (28%) and Deciduous Forest (51%) land cover classifications.*

Current land use immediately surrounding the subject site to the north consists of commercial and residential properties, agricultural lands, and the Porter County Regional Airport. Within 1.5 miles in direct linear measure of the site to the northeast is Ivy Tech Community College Valparaiso. An industrial park is located just east of the site, as well as the Porter County Fairgrounds. Land use to the west and south is primarily agricultural with some residential land use existing near the site.

There is little to no indication of other land uses over the last ninety-three years based on a review of historical aerial imagery dating to 1938 (provided by EDR Radius report). Fourteen epochs from 1938 to 2020 were reviewed to determine the sequential occupancy of the subject site. Since 1938, portions of the subject site have been consistently used for agriculture. The entirety of the site consisted of agricultural land between 1938 and 1952. Historical aerial imagery indicates that the central portion of the site was planted with trees by 1961. The wooded area has remained since that time aside from a small degree of clearing taking place near the single onsite structure between 2008 and 2012. While the reason for the clearing of the trees is not determinate, no detrimental issue is suspected. Historical aerial imagery is included in the EDR Radius Report provided as **Appendix H**.

Current site land use is ideal to support future development of the site for Industrial land uses. Surrounding tract land use is compatible with the intended site use immediately around the buildable area. The land use is indicated from recent aerial imagery and the Porter County and City of Valparaiso Zoning Maps to be Industrial, Commercial, and Agricultural to the north, Agricultural and Residential to the east and south, and Industrial to the west. Adequate buffer to residential areas exists so that they should pose no issue to site development. *Tracts surrounding the subject site, and especially the buildable area, should be considered for rezoning with uses that are compatible with the intended industrial uses of the site. Compatibility with surrounding land use is vital to preserving the competitiveness of the site for an economic development use by preventing encroachment of land uses that would create real or perceived risk to prospective business considering the site for development.*

The site is located within the Airport Overlay (APO) district and the Arterial Roadway Overlay (ARO) district, being located along the US-30 and within proximity of the Porter County Regional Airport. Relevant sections of the Porter County Unified Development Ordinance detailing the overlay districts are provided in **Appendix D**. The full 2013 Porter County Airport Zone Development Plan, relevant sections of the 2009 Porter County Corridor Plan, and relevant sections of the 2001 Porter County Land Use and Thoroughfare Plan are provided in **Appendix M.**

Relevant excerpts from the 2009 City of Valparaiso Unified Development Ordinance (UDO) prescribing zoning and land use polices, standards, and statutory requirements for land development are included in **Appendix D**. The UDO full documents should be consulted for detailed requirements pertaining to land use and zoning district designations.

Threatened and Endangered Species are defined under the federal Endangered Species Act (ESA) of 1973. The ESA provides a program for the conservation of threatened and endangered (T&E) plants and animals and the habitats in which they are found. The lead federal agencies for implementing ESA are the U.S. Fish and Wildlife Service (USFWS) and the U.S. National Oceanic and Atmospheric Administration (NOAA) Fisheries Service. The USFWS maintains a worldwide list of endangered species. Species include birds, insects, fish, reptiles, mammals, crustaceans, flowers, grasses, and trees.

The ESA defines an *endangered species* as "any species which is in danger of extinction throughout all or a significant portion of its range." Endangered species are automatically protected by prohibitions of several types of "take," including harming, harassing, collecting, or killing, under Section 9 of the ESA. There are some limited exceptions to these rules listed in Section 10 of the ESA. The ESA defines a *threatened species* as "any species which is likely to become an endangered species within the foreseeable future throughout all or a significant portion of its range." Threatened species receive protections through separate regulations issued under Section 4(d) of the ESA.

LL+D staff consulted the USFWS Information for Planning and Consultation (IPaC) online tool (https://ipac.ecosphere.fws.gov/) to assess potential project effect on listed species (*a plant or animal that receives federal protections under the Endangered Species Act. Species can be protected as endangered or threatened*) and other USFWS trust resources (*includes migratory birds, species listed as threatened and endangered under the Endangered Species Act, interjurisdictional fishes, marine*

mammals, wetlands, and lands managed by USFWS, such as national wildlife refuges). The IPaC tool is a project planning tool that streamlines the USFWS environmental review process.

An IPaC Resource List was generated for the subject site. The Resource List is a report that automatically generates a list of species and other resources such as critical habitat (collectively referred to as trust resources) under USFWS jurisdiction that are known or expected to be on or near the project area referenced below. The list may also include trust resources that occur outside of the project area, but that could potentially be directly or indirectly affected by activities in the project area. However, determining the likelihood and extent of effects a project may have on trust resources typically requires gathering additional site-specific (e.g., vegetation/species surveys) and project-specific (e.g., magnitude and timing of proposed activities) information.

The IPaC trust resources report lists critical habitats and species of concern known or suspected to be found in habitats within regional ecology. The IPaC trust resources report found that the following species may potentially be affected by activities in this location:

- **Mammals**:
  - Indiana Bat (*Myotis sodalist*) – Endangered
  - Northern Long-eared Bat (*Myotis septentrionalis*) – Endangered
  - Tricolored Bat (*Perimyotis subflavus*) – Proposed Endangered
- **Insects**:
  - Monarch Butterfly (*Danaus plexippus*) – Candidate
- **Critical Habitats**:
  - There are no critical habitats at this location.

The IPaC report also identifies the Migratory Birds Resource List that identifies certain birds protected under the Migratory Bird Treaty Act of 1918 and the Bald and Golden Eagle Protection Act of 1940. Birds listed in the report are birds of particular concern either because they occur on the USFWS Birds of Conservation Concern (BCC) list or warrant special attention within the subject site location. The report does not include a list of every bird found within the site location, nor a guarantee that every bird on this list will be found within the site. The migratory bird list is derived from data provided by the Avian Knowledge Network (AKN). The AKN data is based on a growing collection of survey, banding, and citizen science datasets and is queried and altered to return a list of those birds reported as occurring in the 10km grid cell(s) that intersect the specified site study area location and have been identified as warranting special attention because they are a BCC species or an eagle (Eagle Protection Act requirements may apply) in that area.

The IPaC Migratory Birds Resource List (MBRL) provides a "Probability of Presence" summary indicating the best understanding of when birds of concern are most likely to be present in the site area. *While there is no immediate known impact to site development, the MBRL should be further reviewed within the context of environmental permitting requirements by a qualified environmental/ecological consultant, as temporal migratory bird presence may affect the timing of certain construction-related activities on the subject site*. The IPaC trust resources report is provided in **Appendix E**.

Legacy Environmental Concerns consist of historical activities and events both on the subject site and on nearby tracts where harmful contaminants were released into soil, surface water, and groundwater. If not properly remediated under state and federal regulatory requirements by qualified environmental consultants/contractors, historical contamination liabilities may be inherited through chain of title even if the contamination originated offsite, particularly with migration through groundwater transport. The historical environmental event implication for site development depends on many factors including the type, extent, concentration, complexity, physical setting and surface/subsurface conditions, and time since the event, which may or may not pose a risk to prospective investors on site development.

A cursory review of the subject site and surrounding properties was conducted to identify any potential legacy environmental concerns. Informational resources consulted for this review include:

- EDR Radius Report;
- Recent and historical aerial imagery review;
- US Environmental Protection Agency's (EPA) Enforcement and Compliance History Online (ECHO) database (EDR Radius Report limits ECHO database search to the target property); and
- Information provided through interviews with local political officials, economic development representatives, and landowners (where available)

The EDR Radius Report searches environmental databases for permitted facilities, events, and other potential concerns occurring on the subject site and up to 1.0 mile of the site boundary. EDR use statement: "*A search of available environmental records was conducted by Environmental Data Resources, Inc (EDR). The report was designed to assist parties seeking to meet the search requirements of EPA's Standards and Practices for All Appropriate Inquiries (40 CFR Part 312), the ASTM Standard Practice for Environmental Site Assessments (E 1527-13), the ASTM Standard Practice for Environmental Site Assessments for Forestland or Rural Property (E 2247-16), the ASTM Standard Practice for Limited Environmental Due Diligence: Transaction Screen Process (E 1528-14) or custom requirements developed for the evaluation of environmental risk associated with a parcel of real estate*".

Based on the results of the EDR Radius Report and a cursory review of historical aerial imagery, three environmental legacy concerns were identified on the subject site. Nine other facilities appearing in multiple databases were identified within 1.0 mile of the subject site in the EDR Mapped Sites Summary:

- ***Leaking Underground Storage Tank (LUST), Underground Storage Tank (UST), Historical Auto Stations (EDR Hist Auto), Sites with Restrictions (AUL), Resource Conservation and Recovery Act – Non Generator / No Longer Regulated (RCRA-NonGen/NLR), Facility Registry System (FINDS), Enforcement & Compliance History Information (ECHO)***
    - *Site Name: Quality Oil/Morgan Distributing/Heinfold Oil Company*
    - *Distance: on site*
    - *Elevation: on site*
    - *Map ID* 1 *(overview map below)*

- ***Hazardous Materials Information Reporting System (HMIRS)***
    - *Site Name: 54N 400 E*

- *Distance: on site*
- *Elevation: on site*
- *Map ID* ◆2◆

- ***Ambient Environmental Sampling for PFAS (PFAS WQP)***
  - *Site Name: UMK-10-0027*
  - *Distance: on site*
  - *Elevation: on site*
  - *Map ID* ◆3◆

- ***Leaking Underground Storage Tank (LUST), Underground Storage Tank (UST), RCRA - Very Small Quantity Generators (RCRA-VSQG), Manifest Data (MANIFEST), State Cleanup Program Sites (IN SCP), Asbestos Notification Listing (ASBESTOS)***
  - *Site Name: INDOT Valparaiso Subdistrict*
  - *Distance: within 0.1 miles*
  - *Elevation: higher (751' MSL)*
  - *Map ID* ◆4◆

- ***Leaking Underground Storage Tank (LUST), Underground Storage Tank (UST), Historical Auto Stations (EDR Hist Auto), Resource Conservation and Recovery Act – Non Generator / No Longer Regulated (RCRA-NonGen/NLR), Facility Registry System (FINDS), Enforcement & Compliance History Information (ECHO), Manifest Data (MANIFEST)***
  - *Site Name: Pilot Travel Center*
  - *Distance: within 0.25 miles*
  - *Elevation: higher (751' MSL)*
  - *Map ID* ◆5◆

- ***Leaking Underground Storage Tank (LUST), Underground Storage Tank (UST), NPDES Permit Listing (NPDES), Tier 2 Facility Listing (TIER 2)***
  - *Site Name: Valparaiso Service Center*
  - *Distance: within 0.5 miles*
  - *Elevation: higher (753' MSL)*
  - *Map ID* ◆6◆

- ***Leaking Underground Storage Tank (LUST), Underground Storage Tank (UST), Tier 2 Facility Listing (TIER 2), Superfund Enterprise Management System Archive (SEMS-ARCHIVE), Corrective Action Report (CORRACTS), RCRA - Treatment, Storage and Disposal (RCRA-TSDF), RCRA - Very Small Quantity Generators (RCRA-VSQG), 2020 Corrective Action Program List, FIFRA/ TSCA Tracking System (FTTS), Facility Registry System (FINDS), Enforcement & Compliance History Information (ECHO), Industrial Waste Sites Listing (IND WASTE), Manifest Data (MANIFEST)***
  - *Site Name: Koppers Co Inc/Arch Wood Protection*

- *Distance: within 0.5 miles*
- *Elevation: higher (754' MSL)*
- *Map ID* 7

- ***Superfund Enterprise Management System Archive (SEMS-ARCHIVE), Corrective Action Report (CORRACTS), RCRA - Treatment, Storage and Disposal (RCRA-TSDF), RCRA - Very Small Quantity Generators (RCRA-VSQG), Facility Registry System (FINDS), Enforcement & Compliance History Information (ECHO), Manifest Data (MANIFEST), NPDES Permit Listing***
  - *Site Name: CCA of Indiana, INCO*
  - *Distance: within 0.75 miles*
  - *Elevation: higher (761' MSL)*
  - *Map ID* 8

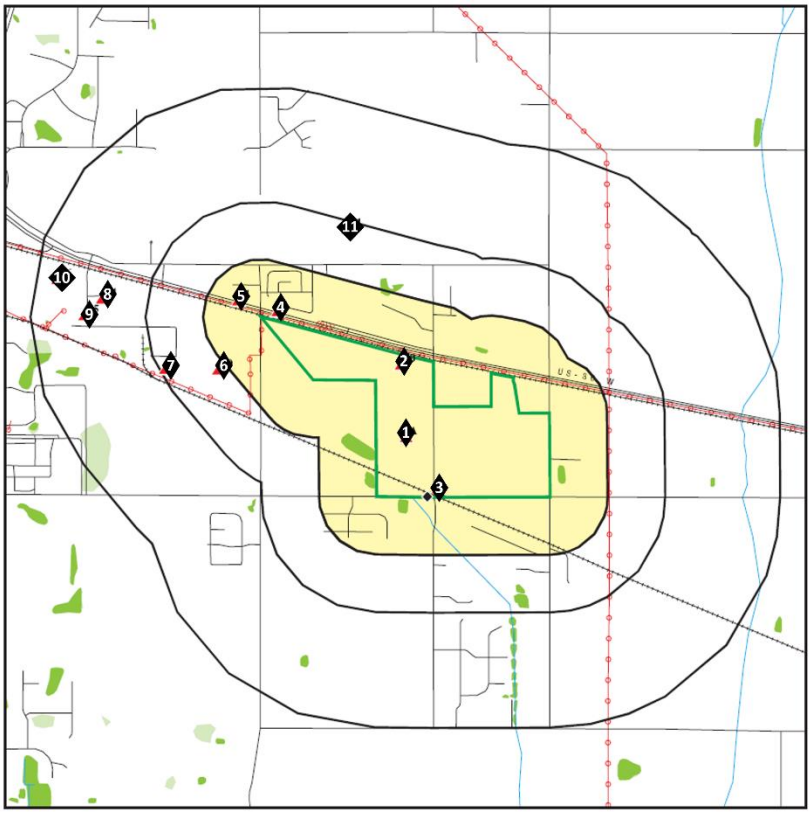
- ***Corrective Action Report (CORRACTS), RCRA - Treatment, Storage and Disposal (RCRA-TSDF), RCRA - Large Quantity Generators (RCRA-LQG), 2020 Corrective Action Program List, Toxic Chemical Release Inventory System (TRIS), Industrial Waste Sites Listing (IND WASTE), Manifest Data (MANIFEST), NPDES Permit Listing, Tier 2 Facility Listing (TIER 2)***
  - *Site Name: AOC LLC*
  - *Distance: within 1.0 mile*
  - *Elevation: higher (760' MSL)*
  - *Map ID* 9

- ***Corrective Action Report (CORRACTS), RCRA - Treatment, Storage and Disposal (RCRA-TSDF), RCRA - Very Small Quantity Generators (RCRA-VSQG), Facility Registry System (FINDS), Enforcement & Compliance History Information (ECHO), Manifest Data (MANIFEST), Superfund Enterprise Management System Archive (SEMS-ARCHIVE), Aerometric Information Retrieval System (AIRS)***
  - *Site Name: UGN Valparaiso*
  - *Distance: within 1.0 mile*
  - *Elevation: higher (760' MSL)*
  - *Map ID* 10

- ***Leaking Underground Storage Tank (LUST), Underground Storage Tank (UST), Tier 2 Facility Listing (TIER 2), NPDES Permit Listing***
  - *Site Name: Porter County Municipal Airport*
  - *Distance: within 0.5 miles*
  - *Elevation: higher (765' MSL)*
  - *Map ID* 11

Map ID 1, identified as Quality Oil/Morgan Distributing/Heinfold Oil Company, raises concerns related to a leaking underground storage tank (LUST) with confirmed groundwater contamination, affecting the site as of 10/25/16. There is record of a reported spill in February 2010 that affected both soil and groundwater. The primary chemicals of concern include PAH (polynuclear aromatic hydrocarbon) and petroleum. The site appears to be mislocated, with the point not matching the actual facility. The site is noted to be in RCRA NonGen/NLR status, and a recent violation in November 2021 has resulted in non-compliance status.

Map ID 2, referred to as "54N 400 E," is located at a warehouse on the northwestern portion of the subject site. There is a record of a hazardous material spillage in 2006.



EDR Radius Report Mapped Sites Overview Map

Map ID 3, known as UMK-10-0027, underwent ambient environmental sampling for PFAS (per- and poly-fluoroalkyl substances) in August 2020. The sampling was conducted by Indiana STORET, and PFAS were detected on site, specifically Perfluorononanoic acid, with measured values ranging from 377 ppt to 7810 ppt. PFAS are man-made chemicals known for their use in various industrial applications and have been linked to potential human health concerns if exposure occurs, such as through drinking water. The accuracy of the site point provided in the EDR Radius Report is in question, as it appears to be at the southernmost portion of the site. More information is required to verify whether the samples were taken on site.

As of 2022, PFAS currently do not meet the criteria for being recognized as an environmental condition (REC) according to the ASTM E1527-21 definition. This status is a result of PFAS not being classified as a "hazardous substance" by the EPA. The EPA's PFAS Strategic Roadmap outlines a plan to designate certain PFAS chemicals as hazardous substances under the Comprehensive Environmental Response, Compensation, and Liability Act (CERCLA) by the summer of 2023. Once this designation takes effect, the impact of PFAS on a property will be considered within the scope of ASTM E1527-21.

The presence of PFAS contamination or the perception of potential contamination could significantly affect the value of a property. The associated legal and financial risks highlight the necessity of conducting

thorough due diligence research. With the impending likelihood of PFAS being classified as hazardous substances under CERCLA, leading to stricter liability, it is crucial to incorporate PFAS assessment into any future Environmental Due Diligence (EDD) during commercial transactions involving potential environmental liabilities.

While a Phase I environmental site assessment (ESA) is the established industry practice, it does not encompass emerging contaminants like PFAS that have not yet been designated as hazardous substances. Therefore, a comprehensive approach to EDD in real estate transactions is advised. This involves initiating a Phase I ESA with an expanded focus to include PFAS assessment. If the Phase I assessment identifies signs of potential contamination (a "Recognized Environmental Concern"), it should trigger a subsequent Phase II ESA.

Map ID 4, also known as INDOT Valparaiso Subdistrict, falls under RCRA-VSQG (Resource Conservation and Recovery Act - Very Small Quantity Generators) and is listed in the Leaking Underground Storage Tank (LUST) and Underground Storage Tank (UST) databases. Groundwater contamination records are present, with contaminants including metals (cadmium) and petroleum compounds (benzene, ethyl benzene, naphthalene, toluene) identified. The site is part of the Indiana State Cleanup Program and has undergone several remediation and monitoring efforts. The point on this site is not clearly placed on any specific facility, so the location is questionable.

The "Pilot Travel Center" site (Map ID 5) is classified under RCRA-NonGen/NLR (Resource Conservation and Recovery Act - Non-Generator/No Longer Regulated) and has a record of one leaking underground storage tank (LUST) that has been discontinued but remains high priority.

Map ID 6, known as Valparaiso Service Center, is classified under RCRA-TSDF (Resource Conservation and Recovery Act - Treatment, Storage, and Disposal Facility), and it is listed in the Leaking Underground Storage Tank (LUST), Underground Storage Tank (UST), NPDES Permit Listing (NPDES), and Tier 2 Facility Listing (TIER 2) databases. There is record of one leaking underground storage tank that is no longer active and listed as low priority.

Map ID 7 refers to Koppers Co Inc/Arch Wood Protection, a chemical manufacturing facility located to the west of the subject site. The facility has received numerous violations in the past, but there have been no violations in the last three years. The site falls under RCRA-VSQG (Resource Conservation and Recovery Act - Very Small Quantity Generators) and is listed in several databases, including Leaking Underground Storage Tank (LUST), Underground Storage Tank (UST), Tier 2 Facility Listing (TIER 2), Superfund Enterprise Management System Archive (SEMS-ARCHIVE), and Corrective Action Report (CORRACTS). The facility is listed as an EPA Corrective Action Facility with a remedial action of "Remedy Construction." Remedy construction is met when a site completes construction of the final remedy designed to achieve long-term protection of human health and the environment.

Map ID 8, known as CCA of Indiana, INCO, represents a metal can manufacturing facility located to the west of the subject site. No violations have been recorded within the last three years, and the site is listed under RCRA-TSDF (Resource Conservation and Recovery Act - Treatment, Storage, and Disposal Facility), among other databases.

Map ID 9 refers to AOC LLC, a plastics material and resin manufacturing facility located to the west of the subject site. A Corrective Action Report indicates past soil contamination on site in the 1990s, but an interim decision for no further action was made in 1993. The site is listed under RCRA-TSDF (Resource Conservation and Recovery Act - Treatment, Storage, and Disposal Facility) and several other databases, including Corrective Action Report (CORRACTS), RCRA-Large Quantity Generators (RCRA-LQG), and 2020 Corrective Action Program List. Like Map ID 7, this facility is also listed as an EPA Corrective Action Facility, indicating ongoing remedial actions to protect human health and the environment.

UGN Valparaiso (Map ID 10) is an referred to as Owens Corning Fiberglass Corp; it is a vehicle parts manufacturing facility. It has a history of low-priority issues in the past, but it has been in compliance in recent years.

Porter County Municipal Airport (Map ID 11) has record of a leaking underground storage tank that is no longer active and is listed as low priority.

In conclusion, the assessment revealed concerns related to leaking underground storage tanks, hazardous material spills, groundwater contamination, and the detection of Per- and poly-fluoroalkyl substances (PFAS) near the subject site. The site has a generally lower elevation compared to the various potential sources of contamination, and this could be a concern for potential onsite contamination. These findings underscore the necessity for rigorous due diligence and sustained monitoring to effectively navigate environmental risks. Full facility information is provided in EDR Radius Report is provided as **Appendix H**.

As the EDR Radius report limits environmental database searches to the subject site and within 1.0 mile of the subject site, the EPA ECHO database was consulted for potential significant environmental concerns within 2.0 miles of the site including active permitted facilities operating under the EPA Clean Water Act, Title V of the Clean Air Act, or the Resource Conservation and Recovery Act (RCRA) for control of solid waste. In limited instances, new air permit applications can be subject to more stringent requirements based on nearby existing permitted facilities' total air emission pollutant volumes and concentrations.

Based on the expanded ECHO search, no environmental legacy concerns were identified on the subject site. No significant environmental concerns within 2.0 miles of the site were found besides those already discussed in the EDR Radius Report. The ECHO site search results are provided in **Appendix H**.

As with any desktop research exercise, actual potential environmental concerns may not be fully recognized or understood without conducting an on-site field investigation. The industry standard for real estate environmental review is the Phase I Environmental Site Assessment (ESA). Governed by the ASTM E1527: *Standard Practice for Environmental Site Assessments: Phase I Environmental Site Assessment Process.* The Phase I ESA is designed to investigate property prior to ownership transfer or improvements for use to identify and document any existing or potential contamination that must be addressed or give cause for liability. The Phase I ESA methodology includes more detailed research and review of environmental databases, historical aerial imagery, title research, and on-site field observations of the subject site and immediately surrounding properties.

Connection

Site connectivity includes access to key transportation assets and utility infrastructure sufficient for the use intensity of the subject site. Access to available workforce is also measured within the context of the intended economic development project use (e.g., heavy industrial, light industrial, commercial/freight logistics, etc.). *The Park 30 East Property is well connected to transportation and utility assets with close proximity to local utilities access (potable water, sewer, electric, natural gas, and telco/broadband). In conjunction with strong community support and adequate workforce availability, the site is well positioned for competitive response to light industrial/manufacturing project opportunities*.

Transportation Assets are in place to serve the logistical needs of commercial/industrial business operations in the area. *Substantial transportation connections to the site include multilane divided U.S. highway frontage and direct access.*

Access to the site is currently available via U.S. Highway 30, a four-lane divided highway that runs along the site's northern boundary. Two points of ingress/egress can be constructed off US-30 along N 325 E and N 400 E. From the site, truck traffic must travel approximately 1.5 miles west on U.S. Highway 30 to access State Route 49 (IN-49), a minor arterial highway. Traffic must then travel 9.0 miles north to reach Indiana Toll Road, Interstate 80/90 (I-80/90). Alternately, truck traffic can travel west US-30 for 17.2 miles to access Interstate 65 (I-65). Traffic must travel through the City of Valparaiso on US-30 before turning onto I-65 in the City of Merrillville. Both routes are comprised of four-lane divided highway. While all roadways leading to interstate access appear to be in good condition and suitable for truck traffic, the 10-mile distance from the site is considered a challenge for certain industry types. A site access map is included in **Appendix A**.

Truck Routes accessible by the site include US-30 for immediate east-west travel and State Route 49 (IN-49) for north-south travel. I-80/90 access is located approximately 10.5 miles north of the site and is an alternate route for east-west travel. I-80/90 is a toll road. I-80/90 can be taken west for 47.1 miles to reach Chicago and multiple other truck routes including I-65, I-57, I-55, I-88, US-41, US-52, and US-34. Multiple US-Highway routes can be taken to get to Indianapolis, including US-35 to US-31, US-35 to US-421, and US-35 to various state roads and I-65. Each of these routes trend generally southward and eventually connect to I-465 as well as various other truck routes including I-74, I-70, and I-69. The routes to Indianapolis are all between 130 and 150 miles from the site to the heart of Indianapolis. Having so many available truck routes is considered a strength for the site. However, being 10.0 miles from interstate access is considered a challenge. A transportation vicinity map is provided in **Appendix A**.

Railroads are directly accessible to the subject site via Chicago, Ft. Wayne & Eastern Railroad (CFE) along the site's northern border, as well as The Norfolk Southern Railroad (NS) along the site's southern border. Both the CFE and NS railroads are directly adjacent to the subject site and provide 4500' and 4300' of frontage respectively. Other nearby railroads include the South Shore Shortline railroad, located approximately 12 miles from the subject site. A transportation vicinity map is provided in **Appendix A**.

Airport access is beneficial for both corporate executives and other business-related representatives to travel to a facility during construction and when operational. Cargo airport access provides an opportunity for transportation of process input materials and product distribution.

Porter County Regional Airport (VPZ) is the primary airport serving Valparaiso and the surrounding area. It is a public-use airport located within 0.5 miles (~1-minute drive time). It is the closest airport to the subject site. VPZ features two runways: one measuring approximately 7,002 by 150 feet and another with a length of about 3,449 by 150 feet, both constructed with asphalt or concrete. Porter County Regional Airport (VPZ) primarily caters to general aviation and corporate traffic, with limited commercial flights. As such, the airport's cargo rates are relatively low, and enplanement rates are primarily based on private and corporate flights.

Gary/Chicago International Airport (GYY) is located 31.6 miles northwest of the subject site (~40-minute drive). The airport has an 8,859-ft runway, which is the 2nd longest in the region and can handle planes up to and including a 777, one of the largest planes in the world. It is a full-service airport with commercial charter, corporate and cargo flights that support the general aviation needs of Porter County.

The Chicago Midway International Airport (MDW) is located 61.6 miles northwest of the site (~1 hour and 12-minute drive). Midway is a major commercial airport, one of the busiest airports in the nation, and the second-busiest airport both in the Chicago metropolitan area and the state of Illinois, serving 7,669,456 passengers in 2021. The Chicago Midway International Airport covers just over one square mile and has five runways.

The Indianapolis International Airport (IND) is approximately 143.0 miles south (~2 hour and 31-minute drive) of the subject site. IND is home to the second largest FedEx Express hub in the world and was ranked as the sixth busiest U.S. airport in terms of air cargo throughput in 2020.

Seaport access is not required for the intended light industrial/manufacturing project uses of the site. However, the nearest seaport is Burns Harbor located within approximately 20.9 miles (~32-minute drive) north of the site. Burns Harbor is a port focused on steel, agriculture, and manufacturing located on Lake Michigan in the heart of the steel industry.

Utility Infrastructure is optimal for the subject site. The City of Valparaiso provides water service and sewer lines, NIPSCO provides natural gas and electric service, and fiber internet, broadband, and copper lines are available for telecommunication needs. Water, sewer, natural gas, and electric lines are all located adjacent to the site. Sewer, natural gas, and electric lines run along the site's northern boundary along US-30. An additional natural gas main runs along N 450 E, and additional electric distribution lines exist along portions of N 400 E and N 450 E in the northern half of the site. Water service requires a short extension from an existing main line to the west of the site on Montedale Park Rd. Fiber-optic and broadband access is located within a mile of the site, and copper lines are also available. Site utility information obtained from the "Local Site Survey Questionnaire" is provided as **Appendix J**. An energy infrastructure and utility access point map is provided as **Appendix A**. Additional utility information can

also be obtained from the county-provided utility map provided as **Appendix F**. Chapter 7 of the 2013 Valparaiso Comprehensive Plan, provided as **Appendix L**, gives further insight into city growth and development potential relative to utility infrastructure.

Potable Water is provided by an existing 12" municipal main line that is operated by the City of Valparaiso and runs along 325 E north of the site. The line would have to be extended into the site across US-30 near the site's northeast corner. Another option is to extend the main line from the industrial facility just west of the site along Montedale Park Rd. The City of Valparaiso's current groundwater system possesses well water limitations, as the nearby Pratt paper mill consumes 20% of the City's daily average water use and 12% of the City's total water capacity. A sufficiently large consumer may require additional water source. Eight new production wells were constructed in 2016, four new wells are being constructed as of 2023, and additional wells will be constructed in 2024. Current and proposed water service flow/capacities should be verified on a project-by-project basis with local water utility officials. Information provided by Porter County in the "Local Site Survey Questionnaire" can be found in **Appendix J**. Additional utility information can be obtained from the county-provided map provided as **Appendix F**. A utility infrastructure overview map can be found in **Appendix A.**

Sewer/Wastewater is available to the subject site with an adjacent 15" municipal line that is operated by the City of Valparaiso and runs along US-30 near the site's northern boundary. The sewer line also runs along CR N 325 E adjacent to the site's northwestern boundary. Local utility officials have stated that the City's largest regional lift station, the Sturdy Road lift station, has limited capacity due to the construction of Pratt Industries, a nearby paper mill. As a result, both the Sturdy Road lift station and the 2-mile force main, originally erected in the 1980s, require upgrades to facilitate the accommodation of larger users and to support future expansion initiatives. Back in 2014, despite the availability of Tax Increment Financing (TIF) funds, there was no interest in constructing a third wastewater plant in the Park 30 East area due to the substantial projected costs, estimated at $15-20 million. Today, the same plant's current cost has risen to over $40 million. This third wastewater plant would be constructed to cater to Pratt Industries and potential future developments. The Valparaiso wastewater utility is actively engaged in designing a comprehensive system upgrade plan encompassing the wastewater treatment plant, aging infrastructure, and pump stations.

Current and proposed capacities should be verified on a project-by-project basis with local sanitary sewage utility officials. Information provided by Porter County in the "Local Site Survey Questionnaire" can be found in **Appendix J**. Additional utility information can be obtained from the county-provided map provided as **Appendix F**. A utility infrastructure overview map can be found in **Appendix A.**

Natural Gas is available via a 12-inch steel distribution main with 60 to 500 psig north of the subject site running along US-30, and a 2-inch distribution main with up to 60 psig east of the site along N 450 E. Natural gas service is provided by NIPSCO. High volume natural gas delivery capability exists and should be able to support large natural gas consumption projects. Upgrades

may be needed depending on customer requirements and should be verified on a project-by-project basis with NIPSCO. Information provided by Porter County in the "Local Site Survey Questionnaire" can be found in **Appendix J**. A utility infrastructure overview map can be found in **Appendix A.**

Electric power is provided by NIPSCO with 12.5kV electric distribution lines adjacent to the site along US-30 as well as portions of N 400 E and N 450 E, and 69kV transmission lines adjacent to the site along US-30. The existing electric infrastructure should be suitable to serve any size project, though an infrastructure analysis should be performed by NIPSCO on a project-by-project basis to verify capacity for handling any new proposed electric load. Information provided by Porter County in the "Local Site Survey Questionnaire" can be found in **Appendix J**. A utility infrastructure overview map can be found in **Appendix A.**

Telco/Broadband distribution is available to the site. Fiberoptic and broadband infrastructure is located less than 1.0 mile from the site. Copper wire-based communication lines are also available. Information provided by Porter County in the "Local Site Survey Questionnaire" can be found in **Appendix J**. A utility infrastructure overview map can be found in **Appendix A.**

Major Market Areas are accessible within a two-hour drive of the subject site. By vehicular travel, the site is situated 58.6 miles from Chicago to the northwest and 136 miles from Indianapolis to the southeast with 2021 total populations of 2,696,555 and 882,039, respectively. Travel distances to major markets and seaports are provided below. A major market vicinity map is provided as **Appendix A.**

Time and Distance to Major Markets

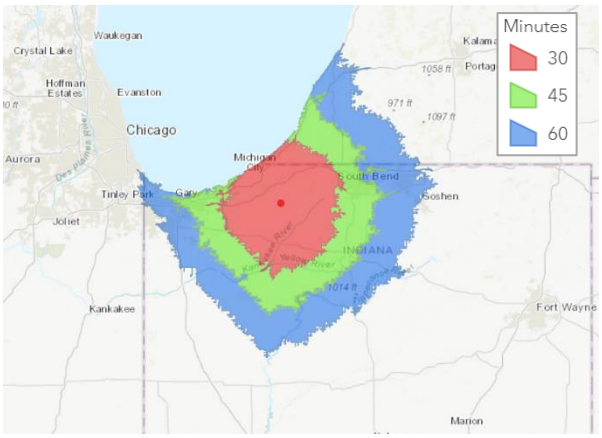
Major Markets	Travel Time	Miles
Chicago, IL	1:03	58.6
Fort Wayne, IN	1:55	104
Indianapolis, IN	2:27	136
Milwaukee, WI	2:33	159
Toledo, OH	3:12	206
Detroit, MI	3:48	248
Cincinnati, OH	4:04	249
Louisville, KY	4:11	254
Columbus, OH	4:29	266
Cleveland, OH	4:36	306
St. Louis, MO	4:59	315
Lexington, KY	5:19	331
Nashville, TN	6:38	429

Time and Distance to Ports

Ports of Indiana	Travel Time	Miles
Burns Harbor	0:31	20.8
Jeffersonville	4:07	253
Mount Vernon	5:15	304

Community

Community aspects conducive to site competitiveness include both measurable and intangible factors that can either strengthen or undermine a site's inherent competitive advantages. While workforce availability and cultural features are commonly accounted for, business and political climate are often neglected, yet serve as an important indicator for both community and governmental desired to welcome new business investment. The Porter County community and political leadership are strong proponents of business growth and new job creation, creating a business climate highly conducive to project investment support through efficient permitting, workforce training, and competitive tax structures. Porter County is committed to supporting long-term industrial and commercial business operations in its communities.



30, 45, 60-minute Drive-time Employment Query

Description of the Economy

Porter County is located in Indiana, a state that boasts a business-friendly environment, solid infrastructure, and substantial creation of manufacturing jobs. The county falls within the Northwest region of Indiana and has a population of 174,243 (US Census Bureau). Valparaiso, the county seat, has a population of 34,428 (US Census Bureau). The largest city in the county is Portage with a 2021 population of 38,192. The county's strong commitment to industry helps to drive local drive economic growth. Porter County is part of and influenced by the Chicago Metropolitan Statistical Area (MSA), an area that spans 19 counties throughout the Midwestern United States and had a 2020 census population of 9,618,502. Further information about City of Valparaiso population trends can be found in the 2013 Valparaiso Comprehensive Plan, relevant sections provided as **Appendix L.**

Demographics

Porter County had a 2020 population density of approximately 407 persons per square mile, greater than the state average of 189 ppsm, and is the ninth most populated county in the State of Indiana. Over the last ten years, Porter County experienced an annual population growth rate of 0.5%. The population, considering race alone or in combination with one other race, is roughly 85.6% White, 10.8% Black or African American, 2.8% Asian, 0.8% Native American, 0.1% Pacific Islander, and and 2.5% some other race. Approximately 6.9% of the population are Hispanic or Latino. The county's median age is 37.7.

Employment and the Economy and Income

Porter County, IN is home to a highly engaged and skilled local workforce with a total resident labor force of approximately 83,645 people. The county unemployment rate of 4.4% is slightly lower than the state average rate of 4.8%. According to the 2020 US Census Bureau, Manufacturing, Health Care & Social Assistance, and Educational Services make up the largest industries in the county, employing 16.9%,

14.4%, and 9.9% of workers, respectively. The Manufacturing sector employs 13,593 people, Health Care & Social Assistance employs 11,647 people, and Educational Services employs 8,032 people. In 2020, the highest paying industries in Porter County for men, by median annual earnings, were Manufacturing ($80,053), Finance & Insurance and Real Estate/Rental & Leasing ($76,972), and Wholesale Trade ($70,684). The industries with the best median earnings for women were Agriculture, Forestry, Fishing & Hunting, and Mining ($48,646), Finance & Insurance and Real Estate/Rental & Leasing ($43,318), and Manufacturing ($41,908). Median household income is $71,152, which is greater than the median annual income of $62,843 across the United States.

Population/Workforce *within a 60-minute drive time from the site include a total population of more than 1,560,111 and 46,587-plus businesses employing over 695,129 people according to Esri 2022 demographic data. Construction, manufacturing, and professional, scientific, & technical services account for 17.9% of businesses employing 23.1% of total workforce within the 60-mile radius of the site*. A 30, 45, and 60-minute drive-time query of employment numbers for construction and manufacturing jobs (by NAICS Code) was performed for the subject site. The following employment numbers were reported:

30, 45, 60-minute Drive-time Employment Count*

Business Type by NAICS Codes	Employees		
	30-min	**45-min**	**60-min**
Construction	9,240	22,835	41,815
Manufacturing	20,796	55,082	98,340
Professional, Scientific & Tech Services	6,314	14,234	30,816
Totals	**36,350**	**92,151**	**170,971**

**Source: Copyright 2022 Infogroup, Inc. All rights reserved. Esri Total Residential Population forecasts for 2022.*

City of Valparaiso target industries include health care, manufacturing, construction, higher education, and technology. With access to a total workforce of over 741,673 which includes 170,971-plus employed in construction, manufacturing, and professional, scientific, and technical services sectors, adequate workforce availability should meet medium to large-scale project labor demands of Valparaiso industry targets. Population and business summary reports are provided in **Appendix I**.

Cultural Features within three miles of the subject site that may pose community risk or public opposition to industrial development are limited and generally do not affect site permitting, construction, or facility operation. Fire and police protection and emergency medical services are within relatively close proximity of the subject site, however, located in the town of Bronson, these facilities do not pose cross-transportation risks for site construction or facility operation. A cultural features map is provided in **Appendix A**.

Schools are concentrated within the municipal limits of the City of Valparaiso. There is only one day care center within three miles of the subject site. The Kesling Intermediate School is located about a mile northwest of the subject site across U.S. Highway 30 (US-30) on Eastport Center

Drive. US-30 may be an access route for some students. Still, with the site over a mile away and truck traffic having access to a four-lane highway, the day-care should not pose any issues to site development.

Churches are largely concentrated within the municipal limits of the City of Valparaiso and the surrounding areas. There are four churches within three miles of the subject site buildable area. All nearby churches are over 1 mile from the site and are sufficiently removed from the site's operational footprint (e.g., buildable area). As such, the site poses no significant operational proximity or transportation risks to these churches. The closest church to the site, Valley Baptist Church, is over 1.5 miles from the subject site.

Cemeteries are largely concentrated within the municipal limits of the City of Valparaiso and the surrounding areas. There are 5 cemeteries within 3 miles of the subject site. Luther Cemetery is the only cemetery within 1 mile of the site's buildable area, though this should pose no risk to site permitting or operation.

Group Care Centers including nursing homes, assisted living centers, special education schools, crisis units, and hospice facilities do not exist immediately proximate to the site or along principal site access routes. The closest facility, Brickyard Healthcare, is located on Sturdy Road about 3.2 miles from the site.

Other Cultural Centers including libraries, museums and art galleries, movie theaters and performing arts centers, zoos and aquariums, arboreta and botanical gardens, and planetariums do not exist immediately proximate to the site. Brauer Museum of Art is located on Sturdy Road, within Valparaiso University. The museum is over 3 miles from the site and should not pose a threat to industrial development.

Parks and Protected Lands do not exist immediately proximate to the site or along principal site access routes. The Porter County Fairground is approximately 1.5 miles southwest of the site on IN State Road 49. Will Park is located 4.4 miles away in Valparaiso on Morgan Blvd. These areas are sufficiently removed from the operational footprint of the site (e.g., buildable area) and are buffered by agricultural lands and other development. Site ingress/egress road access does not intersect or share park access. A protected lands map is provided in **Appendix A**.

Correctional Facilities including federal, state, and local prisons and detention centers do not exist immediately proximate to the site or along principal site access routes. The Porter County Juvenile Detention Center is located along State Road 2 (IN-2) over 5 miles away from the subject site. The Westville Correctional Facility is located approximately 11.0 miles north of the site via IN State Road 2.

Fire Protection/EMS is provided by the Valparaiso Fire Department Station 1 located within a 5.0-mile driving distance of the site access point. The response route is roughly 9 minutes, with trucks taking Indiana St, Washington St, and US-30 to the site. The Wanatah Fire Department is also located 5.1 miles and 6-minute drive from the site with trucks taking Illinois St, and then US-

30 to the site. The Morgan Twp Volunteer Fire Department is another option located 6.2 miles and a 10-minute drive from the site with the response route running from IN State Road 49 to US-30 and to the site. Fire and EMS response time and capacity should be locally verified.

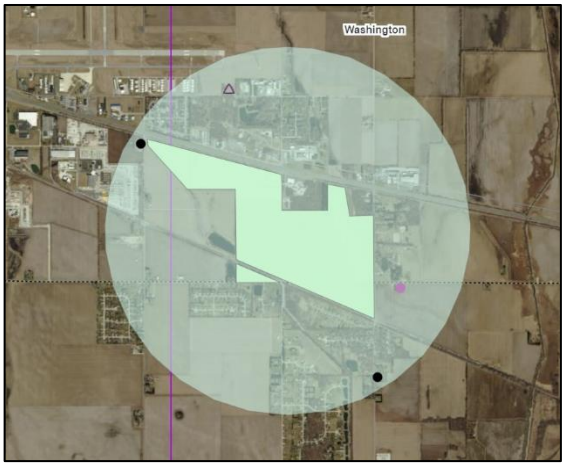
Law Enforcement is provided by the Porter County Sheriff's office located within 3.0 miles of the site boundary/buildable area. The response route is IN-49 to US-30 and is approximately a 5-minute drive time from the site. The Valparaiso Police Department is another option and is located 4.8 miles and an 8-minute drive from the site access point. Law enforcement response time and capacity should be locally verified.

Hospital/Emergency Care is provided by two different hospitals within 10 miles of the subject site. Northwest Health - Porter is located 9.9 miles (~13-minute drive time) from the site via US-6, IN-49 and US-30 to the site. It is an acute care hospital with 300 total staffed beds. Valparaiso Health Center is located 7.1 miles (~10-minute drive time) from the site via Memorial drive, Burlington Beach Rd, IN-49, US-30 and then to the site. The hospital is an immediate and urgent care center in the Porter County area. EMS response time and capacity should be locally verified.

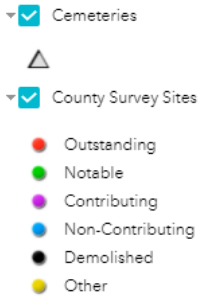
Historical Preservation records include locations of cultural or archaeological significance, some of which are formally designated as state and/or federally protected historical resources under State Historic Preservation Offices (SHPO) and/or National Register of Historic Places registrations. Historical resources, if located on the subject site, may alter, impede, or preclude development if potential for disturbance or encroachment exists. Historical resources located near the subject site may warrant mitigating site planning and design elements such as line-of-site buffering between facilities and a historically significant structure. The Indiana Department of Natural Resources (IDNR) houses the Division of Historic Preservation and Archaeology (DHPA), which promotes the conservation of Indiana's cultural resources. The DHPA facilitates state and federal preservation programs and is the staff of the State Historic Preservation Office. The DHPA's Archaeology Team administers programs for protecting and preserving Indiana's prehistoric and historic archaeological sites, is the central repository of archaeological records and reports, and houses the state's official computerized database of archaeological site information.

Several cultural resource GIS datasets from the IDNR were consulted for potential location of culturally or historically significant resources on or near the subject site. These datasets are collected and contained within the State Historic Architectural and Archaeological Research Database (SHAARD), which allows users to search cultural resource information on known historic and archaeological resources throughout the State of Indiana. SHAARD includes data from the Indiana Historic Sites and Structures Inventory county survey (IHSSI), the Indiana Cemetery and Burial Ground Registry, historic bridges and canals, historic theaters, and properties listed in the National Register of Historic Places and the Indiana Register of Historic Sites and Structures. The data contained in SHAARD was collected from previously conducted cultural resource inventories, National Register nominations, and cultural resource management projects. SHAARD and associated resource maps are ongoing initiatives and are updated daily, so the absence of data does not necessarily indicate the absence of resources. A more formal archaeological survey may be necessary prior to site development.

A desktop data review was conducted regarding available records for potential cultural resources present on the subject property. *The SHAARD database identified no archaeological sites and no historic structures on the subject site. Four cultural resources were identified within a 1-mile radius of the subject site's centroid. These include one cemetery with a "Contributing" rating, one farm with a "Contributing" rating, and two "Demolished" historical features.* Of the four IHSSI resources within a mile of the subject site, two are rated "Contributing". The "C" rating means that the properties met the basic inventory criterion of being pre-1970 but are not important enough to qualify individually for inclusion in the National Register. Such resources are treated as important to the destiny or continuity of an area's historic fabric. Two properties were rated "D", or "Demolished", meaning they have been demolished since the original survey information was gathered. *None of the identified cultural resources should present significant impediments to the development of the subject site. All other historically significant resources are located outside the 1-mile buffer surrounding the subject site centroid and are not likely to impact site development potential.* The SHAARD/IHSSI Reports for all indicated historical features within one mile of the site are provided as **Appendix K**, and the Historic Resource search map is provided as **Appendix A**.



SHAARD Map Search



As with any desktop research exercise, actual potential historic preservation concerns may not be fully recognized or understood without conducting an on-site field investigation. The industry standard for real estate environmental review is the Phase I Cultural Resources Survey. The primary objective of a Phase I archaeological survey is to identify and record all cultural resources within a project area. Cultural resources can include prehistoric Native American habitation sites, historic farmstead sites, standing structures, or other man-made features such as earthworks, old roadbeds, or cemeteries. The Phase I survey process typically begins with Phase IA Archaeological Reconnaissance to conduct historical research, environmental context review, and field inspection. When an archaeological site is encountered, a full written report must be submitted following guidance provided in the Current Guidebook for Indiana Historic Sites and Structures Inventory—Archaeological Sites and the Indiana Cultural Resources Manual.

Indiana Code 14-21-1 provides protection for archaeological sites and historic burial sites regardless of their location on state or private lands. All archaeological sites with artifacts dating before December 31, 1870 are protected under this act. Human burial sites are afforded protection under IC 14-21-1, IC 14-21-2, IC 23-14 (Indiana General Cemetery Act). The State of Indiana implements specialized reviews that provide protection to historic properties on state-owned or leased land or to historic properties that are listed in the National Register of Historic Places or the Indiana Register of Historic Sites and Structures and that will be altered, demolished, or removed using state funds. These review processes are established in Sections 14, 16, and 18 of Indiana Code 14-21-1. In addition, projects that will disturb the ground within

100 feet of a cemetery or burial ground for the purpose of excavating or covering the ground or erecting, altering, or repairing any structure are reviewed in Sections 26-26.5. In order to increase the confidence in understanding any potential historical preservation concerns for the subject site, it is recommended that a Phase I archaeological survey be conducted by a qualified cultural resource management/archaeological consulting professional and that archaeology state laws listed in Title 14, Article 21 of the Indiana Code are thoroughly understood. Relevant sections of the Indiana Code are provided as **Appendix K.** Information regarding Indiana Archaeology Law, complete with links to the full Indiana Code and Indiana Administrative Code, is also provided as **Appendix K.**

Education and Technical Training Assets are well positioned to serve professional and technical workforce needs of Porter County target industries, while colleges and universities provide valuable recruiting opportunities to local businesses.

The Indiana Department of Workforce Development (DWD) offers a variety of services to statewide job seekers looking to enter the workforce, return to the workforce, or locate education and training opportunities. These include Hoosier Talent Network, INDemand Jobs, Indiana Career Explorer, Indiana Career Connect, Cyberseek Indiana, and Indiana Career Ready. The DWD offers several services including job search help, hiring events, training grants, specialized training and more: https://www.in.gov/dwd/.

Indiana's WorkOne Career Centers are the heart of the workforce development system, providing assistance in understanding jobs in demand today, helping workers determine their interests and abilities, offering access to training opportunities, and providing information needed to succeed in today's economy. WorkOne's Job Opportunities and Business Services (JOBS) Program assists employers in locating and developing a skilled team by determining eligibility, recruiting employees, formulating WorkKeys job profiles, and providing skills assessments to identify gaps and training needs. WorkOne's WIN Career Readiness is a fundamental workplace skills training system available to Indiana residents, employers and training providers. Both the DWD's Work Opportunity Tax Credit (WOTC) and Federal Bonding Program benefits employers by offering incentives for hiring jobseekers who may traditionally have difficulty finding employment.

Next Level Jobs provides free training for Indiana workers and reimbursements for Indiana employers for training employees in high-demand fields. Next Level Jobs assists job seekers by providing Indiana residents with free training in high-growth job fields and the opportunity for them to earn a high-value certificate in one of Indiana's in-demand job fields, tuition free. Next Level Jobs assists employers with reimbursements for training their employees through the Employer Training Grant, which will reimburse an employer for up to $5,000 per trained employee who is trained, hired, and retained for six months, granting up to $50,000 per employer.

The Center of Workforce Innovations is a non-profit corporation dedicated to addressing workforce development needs. The Center acts on behalf of the Local Workforce Investment Board which serves several counties in Northwest Indiana, providing education resources and workforce training assistance.

Valparaiso University is located approximately 7 minutes driving time from the subject site. It is a private independent Lutheran university with five undergraduate colleges and a graduate school. The university had an undergraduate enrollment of 2,719 in the fall of 2020.

Ivy Tech Community College is a two-year vocational/technical college with a campus in Valparaiso that is a 6-minute drive from the site. Other locations surrounding the site within 50 miles in direct linear measure are in the cities of South Bend, Michigan City, and Crown Point. Ivy Tech specializes in developing programs geared towards specific skills needed for existing manufacturers and other industries. A healthcare-focused vocational education facilities, Ross Medical Education Center, is also located nearby in the City of South Bend.

The University of Notre Dame du Lac (Notre Dame), a private Catholic research university outside the City of South Bend, is located within a 52-minute drive time of the site. Notre Dame has been recognized as one of the top universities in the United States and has been at the forefront in research and scholarship and had a total undergraduate enrollment of 8,874 in the fall of 2020.

Other Indiana higher education centers within approximately 50 miles of the subject site include two Purdue University campuses (Northwest-Hammond Campus and Northwest-Westville Campus), Indiana Wesleyan University – Merrillville, two Indiana University campuses (Northwest Campus and South Bend Campus), and Marian University's Ancilla College.

The site is within reach of several colleges and trade schools in the Chicago area, which is within an approximate 70-minute drive time, including the University of Illinois at Chicago, DeVry University Illinois, DePaul University, University of Chicago, Northwestern University, Loyola University Chicago, and Illinois Institute of Technology.

Business Climate is highly favorable for bringing in quality job-creating businesses to the area. Indiana is considered one of the best states in the nation for long-term fiscal stability and low corporate income tax rates, creating a business-forward environment throughout the state. The State of Indiana's target Industries according to the IEDC include advanced manufacturing, aerospace and aviation, ag-bioscience, defense, life sciences, logistics and transportation, and technology. These industries can take advantage of existing transportation assets throughout the state and county to serve an array of unique business logistical needs. The following target industries are listed by the Valparaiso Economic Development Corporation: health care, manufacturing, construction, higher education, and technology.

Porter County has a labor force of 83,645 and an unemployment rate of 4.4%. Business development and assistance is provided locally by Porter County Government, City of Valparaiso Government, and the Valparaiso Economic Development Corporation (VEDC).

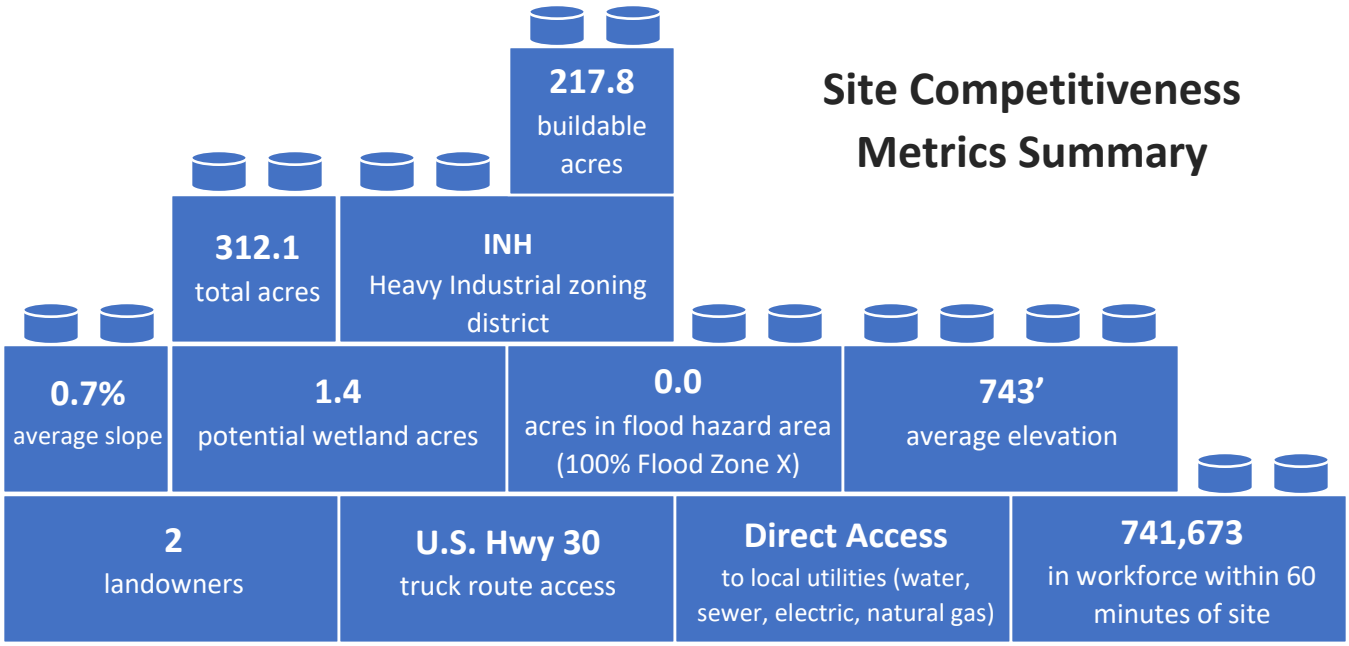
Local incentives are offered to support businesses, including project tax abatement to phase-in the payment of real and personal property taxes of a business investing in Valparaiso, Tax Increment Financing

(TIF) to invest resources in maximizing the redevelopment of a designated area on a project-by-project basis, ValpoNet Fiber Infrastructure to provide ample cost effective fiber connectivity throughout the city, and "Shovel-Ready" Assistance to place commercial property in Valparaiso in the best position to sell and be developed. Further information about local economic development assets and workforce opportunities can be found in Chapter 4 of the 2012 Valparaiso Comprehensive Plan, provided as **Appendix L**.

In addition, the IEDC provides for a variety of programs and initiatives offering business support and expertise to companies that are investing and creating jobs in Indiana. These include the Indiana Regional Cities Initiative, Certified Technology Park program, Broadband Ready Communities program, and Next Level Roads program.

The State of Indiana offers a variety of incentives for all types of businesses, including targeted industries, workforce training, infrastructure and special opportunity incentives. Indiana's business tax structure is competitive—the corporate income tax is decreasing to 4.9%, and the state offers many business tax incentives, corporate tax credits and economic development programs. Statewide incentives include the Community Revitalization Enhancement District (CRED) Tax Credit, Data Center Gross Retail and Use Tax Exemption, Economic Development for a Growing Economy (EDGE) Tax Credit, Industrial Grant Fund (IDGF), Tax Exemption for Patent-derived Income, Skills Enhancement Fund (SEF), Venture Capital Investment Tax Credit program, Hoosier Business Investment (HBI) Tax Credit, Research Expense Credits, Research and Development Sales Tax Exemption, and Redevelopment Tax Credit (RTC).

Political Climate is strong according to interviews with local officials, and the community is largely in favor of commercial/industrial business development to bring long-term economic growth to the area.



Rough Order-of-Magnitude Site Development Cost Summary

A rough order-of-magnitude (ROM) cost estimation for pre-construction site preparation and utility and transportation infrastructure improvements was calculated to provide a general understanding of potential site development costs. ROM costs were calculated for the 217.8-acre buildable area, which was devised to avoid more costly site leveling due to elevation/slope conditions occurring on the eastern-southeastern perimeter of the site. ROM cost tables for the buildable area are presented below.

Notes:

- *Does not include costs for engineering, permitting, or general project management.*
- *This cost estimate was prepared with the best information available at the time of analysis.*
- *Actual costs can vary based on availability of material, site conditions, and labor.*
- *ROM costs generated from GIS data and use of RSMeans construction cost estimating software.*

ROM Costs for 18127-020 Buildable Area (217.8 acres)

Project: 18157-001
Location: Tippacanoe, IN

WORK ACTIVITY	QUANTITY	UNIT	UNIT COST	SUBTOTAL	TOTAL
ON-SITE PREPARATION					
Site Clearing					
Mobilization	1.00	EA	$40,000.00	$40,000.00	
Demolition (Structure)	1.00	EA	$25,000.00	$25,000.00	
Clearing	5.00	AC	$2,500.00	$12,500.00	
Topsoil Strip/Cut	250066.67	CY	[illegible]	$577,654.00	
Total Site Clearing				$655,154.00	$655,154.00
Grading Cut					
Earth Cut	859393.00	[illegible]	$3.50	$3,007,875.50	
Total Grading Cut				$3,007,875.50	$3,007,875.50
Grading Fill					
Earth Fill	859[illegible]93.00	CY	$3.50	$3,007,875.50	
Total Grading Fill				$3,007,875.50	$3,007,875.50
Other Preparation					
Fine Grading (Building)	[illegible].00	SY	$1.45	$0.00	
Fine Grading (Non-Building)	[illegible].00	SY	$0.95	$0.00	
Erosion Control	100.00	AC	$2,500.00	$250,000.00	
Seeding	300.00	AC	$1,250.00	$375,000.00	
Total Other Preparation				$625,000.00	$625,000.00
			TOTAL		**$7,295,905.00**
OFF-SITE IMPROVEMENTS					
Road Improvements					
Turning Lane Left (300')	1.00	EA	$196,086.42	$196,086.42	
Turning Lane Right (300')	1.00	EA	$189,320.60	$189,320.60	
Total Road Improvements				$385,407.02	$385,407.02
			TOTAL		**$385,407.02**

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Project: 18157-001
Location: Tippacanoe, IN

WORK ACTIVITY	QUANTITY	UNIT	UNIT COST	SUBTOTAL	TOTAL
ON-SITE IMPROVEMENTS					
Paving - Asphalt					
Asphalt Paving - Drives (Light Duty)	0.00	SY	$19.06	$0.00	
Asphalt Paving - Drives (Heavy Duty)	83700.00	SY	$25.32	$2,119,551.84	
Total Paving - Asphalt				$2,119,551.84	$2,119,551.84
			TOTAL		**$2,119,551.84**
UTILITIES & DRAINAGE					
Water	4600.00	LF	$65.00	$299,000.00	
Sewer	3100.00	LF	$75.00	$232,500.00	
Subsurface Drainage	3100.00	LF	$132.00	$409,200.00	
Drainage Outfall	1.00	EA	00,000.00	$100,000.00	
3 Phase Electrical	3100.00	LF	$189.00	$585,900.00	
Total Utilities				$1,626,600.00	$1,626,600.00
			TOTAL		**$1,626,600.00**
RAIL					
Spur	00.00	LF	$500.00	$1,500,000.00	
Crossing	00	EA	$80,000.00	$80,000.00	
Switch	2	EA	$500,000.00	$1,000,000.00	
Total Rail Improvements				$2,580,000.00	$2,580,000.00
			TOTAL		**$2,580,000.00**
WETLAND MITIGATION(opt al)					
Compensatory Mitigation (u rified)	0.00	AC	$109,200.00	$0.00	
Total Mitigation (not indluding ntractor sts)				$0.00	$0.00
			TOTAL		**$0.00**
				SUB-TOTAL	**$14,007,463.86**
			Construction Contingency 10%		$1,400,746.39
			Total Cost Estimate For Site Construction w/o Mitigation		**$15,408,210.25**
			Total Cost Estimate For Site Construction with Mitigation		**$15,408,210.25**
SOFT COSTS					
Engineering				9.00%	$1,386,738.92
Surveying & Staking				2.50%	$385,205.26
Testing & Inspecting				1.00%	$154,082.10
Construction Management				4.75%	$731,889.99
Studies					$100,000.00
			TOTAL		**$2,757,916.27**
			Total Cost Estimate For Site		**$18,166,126.51**

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Site Competitiveness Report Card

The Site Competitiveness Report Card is an indicator of favorable development conditions across customary competitiveness factors. A relative score for each factor is given as a letter grade, akin to a 4.0 education grade point average (GPA). The GPA is calculated for each competitiveness area: Condition, Connection, and Community with an overall site GPA derived as a relative indicator of site competitiveness for an economic development land use.

Competitiveness Driver			
Condition		Comments	3.2
Engineering			
	*Elevation/Slope*		A
	*Flood Risk*		A
	*Buildable Configuration*		B
	*Land Cover*		A-
Environmental/Cultural Resource			
	*Potential Wetlands*		A
	*Legacy Environmental Liabilities*		D
	*Potential T&E Risk*		A
Connectivity			3.6
Transportation			
	*Interstate*		C
	*Multi-lane Truck Route*		A
	*Class I Rail*		A
	*Airport (passenger)*		A
	*Airport (cargo)*		A
	*Seaport/Inland Port*		A
Utilities			
	*Potable Water*		B
	*Sewer/Wastewater Treatment*		B
	*Natural Gas*		A
	*Electric*		A
	*Broadband/Fiber*		A
Community			4.0
Cultural			
	*Compatibility with Surrounding Land Use*		A
	*Community Acceptance*		A
Economic			
	*Market Vitality*		A
	*Tax Incentives*		A
Labor			
	*Workforce*		A
	*Wage Competitiveness*		A
Political			
	*Permitting Expediency*		A
	*Business Climate*		A

Site GPA



Site Competitiveness Opinion

Overall, the Park 30 East Property in the City of Valparaiso, Porter County is a competitive greenfield site that is a good prospect for light industrial and advanced manufacturing project opportunities.

The site has several competitive features that position it as a strategic real estate asset to support economic development. Firstly, the site has access to all major utilities including electricity, natural gas, wastewater & sewer, potable water, and broadband/fiber. The site also offers a large contiguous PAD of over 200 acres that is mostly flat and dry with favorable soils for large-scale industrial development. There is a skilled workforce in the area and a population of over 1.5 million within a 60-minute drivetime The site's unique strength lies in its dual rail-lines – the CFE shortline and Norfolk Southern main line – bordering its north and south boundaries. Collaboration with these rail lines to explore the possibility of rail spurs could enhance the site's readiness for potential future enterprises. Moreover, its strategic proximity to regional and international airports with freight and commercial services adds to its appeal. The site is in an ideal position for truck access with several different routes available to reach the nearby metropolitan areas of Indianapolis and Chicago including I-65, I-80/90, and I-94. There should not be any uncertainty regarding property availability, as Porter County economic development officials have confirmed that the landowner is actively promoting the site for sale. With industrial zoning in place and Porter County community and political leadership working together as strong proponents of business growth and new job creation, quick permitting expediency should also be expected. Finally, there are nearby hospitals, law enforcement, fire protection, and EMS to provide services to future on-site facilities.

Some challenges for the site also exist, including potential onsite environmental legacy issues, distance from interstate access, and a county road splitting the buildable area down the middle. Currently when leaving the site, truck traffic must travel a minimum of 10.0 miles to access the interstate. While all roadways leading to interstate access appear to be in good condition and suitable for truck traffic, the 10.0-mile distance is considered a challenge. It is recommended that a focus be placed on attracting industries that have a tolerance for being without direct interstate access. Having direct access to a four-lane U.S. Highway and multiple different routes to large metropolitan areas should be sufficient in attracting a variety of desired industry types. Integrating CR N 400 E within the buildable area could significantly enhance the flexibility of potential facility footprints.

Furthermore, the site could potentially face onsite contamination concerns stemming from nearby manufacturing facilities. Potential issues include leaking underground storage tanks, hazardous material spills, groundwater contamination, and the presence of PFAS in the soil. The evolving regulatory landscape regarding PFAS highlights the importance of factoring PFAS assessment into future Environmental Due Diligence (EDD) procedures. Incorporating an expanded focus on PFAS assessment within the Phase I environmental site assessment (ESA) could provide valuable insights. Should indications of contamination emerge, a subsequent Phase II ESA might be warranted.

Considering the comprehensive evaluation presented in the SSI Phase II Report, the Park 30 East Property emerges as a nationally competitive site for attracting impactful light industrial and manufacturing projects to Porter County. Its direct utility access, connection to a four-lane U.S. Highway, expansive and

suitable buildable area, ample workforce availability, and alignment with industrial zoning and landowner interests all position it as a prime candidate for development.

Subject Site Key Facts

Advantages	Disadvantages
A mostly regular-shaped buildable area of over 200 contiguous buildable acres is available.	The site's buildable area is divided in half by CR N 400 E, thus limiting the size of potential facility footprints. Incorporating this road into the site's buildable area would offer much more flexibility and result in a larger contiguous PAD.
The site is flat with minimal changes in elevation and an average slope of 0.7%. It has low flood risk, no recorded or observed hydrography features, and minimal wetlands across the entirety of the buildable area.	While all roadways leading to interstate access appear to be in good condition and suitable for truck traffic, the 10-mile distance from the site is considered a challenge for certain industry types.
Porter County community and political leadership are strong proponents of business growth and new job creation creating a business climate highly conductive to project investment.	As of the date of this report, no known real estate purchase option agreement is held with any person or organization with the landowners for any portion of the site. LL+D strongly recommends that Porter County pursue and secure a real estate purchase option agreement with the landowners. This is critically important to reduce uncertainty regarding property availability and price.
The majority of the buildable area has soils that are very favorable for an industrial project land use. Good performance and very low maintenance can be expected.	The existing capacity for sewer/wastewater and potable water could limit certain industry types. The Valparaiso wastewater utility is actively engaged in designing a comprehensive system upgrade plan encompassing the wastewater treatment plant, aging infrastructure, and pump stations.
The surrounding land use is ideal to support the development of light industrial and advanced manufacturing project land uses.	
The site has direct access to a four-lane US highway (US-30) for truck traffic ingress/egress. The site also has access to two separate rail lines, CFE shortline to the north and Norfolk Southern mainline to the south.	The subject site is near several environmental legacy concerns including leaking underground storage tanks, hazardous material spills, groundwater contamination, and the detection of PFAS. There is potential risk that the nearby contamination has migrated onto the subject site. A more extensive environmental site investigation on the subject site by a qualified consultant is needed to better understand potential onsite contamination.
Porter County economic development officials have confirmed that the two landowners are actively promoting the site for sale.	
Access to surrounding labor markets at competitive wage rates is well within reach of the subject site.	
There is a high workforce population relative to other counties in Indiana, with greater than 1,500,000 within a 60-minute drive time of the site.	

Purpose and Use of Study

Sites originating from Phase I have demonstrated qualitative compliance with engineering. environmental, infrastructure, and cultural location criteria. That said, in order to develop an actionable understanding of true site competitiveness, a more detailed study of the subject site is required. SSI Phase II: Preliminary Due Diligence is designed for this purpose.

Purpose

The purpose of the SSI Phase II study is to provide an understanding of the subject site's advantages and challenges in conjunction with a ROM cost estimate to improve site functional use and mitigate development challenges. The SSI Phase II study is a desktop-based preliminary due diligence exercise performed by discipline-specific experts with experience in industrial and commercial property development. Study of the subject site's physical and surrounding characteristics, assets, and impediments for development are reviewed in sufficient detail to formulate a defendable opinion on the competitive value of the property for economic development.

Use

There are three primary intended uses of an SSI Phase II report: (1) site advancement decision support; (2) consideration for investment in site improvements; and (3) site marketing. Each intended use is discussed below.

Site Advancement Decision

The SSI Phase II study is designed to provide decision support for the advancement of sites to market though the landowner engagement process. SSI Phase II findings serve as an indicator for the likelihood the subject site will survive the intensive scrutiny of formal, field-based engineering and environmental due diligence. Detection of severe site deficiencies or encumbrances, often referred to as fatal flaws, during desktop preliminary due diligence can avoid expenditure of significant resources in subjecting sites with little chance of survival to formal due diligence. Short of fatal flaws, SSI Phase II may reveal less than ideal conditions or less severe yet concerning challenges that can marginalize site competitiveness or be detrimental to business attraction, respectively. The most important use of the SSI Phase II study is to ensure confidence in the decision to advance sites to market graduation through subsequent phases for landowner engagement and formal due diligence. *Ultimately, site advancement decisions should be tempered by local industry targets and the host community's real estate needs to support those targets.*

Site Improvement Investment Considerations

The findings of the Phase II study, along with an estimate of the ROM costs needed to make functional site and infrastructure improvements, provides concrete data for Economic Development Offices (EDOs) to consider while making investment decisions to improve site marketability. There may be strong business cases for increasing site competitiveness by making incremental investment in infrastructure improvements or mitigation of development challenges. There are many conditions to be considered in investing significant dollars on speculative site improvements including market, economic, fiscal, real

estate, and political factors. While the information provided through the SSI Phase II study should not be exclusively considered for site improvement expenditures, the findings may provide an initial quasi prospectus on site development expenditure and associated return-on-investment (ROI).

Site Marketing

The best greenfield site in America is of no consequence to the host community if industry prospects are unaware of its value and availability. Many EDOs invest in branding and marketing campaigns to showcase their community's differentiating attributes to attract business investment. If prematurely launched, many communities unfortunately become "the dog that caught the car". The well-qualified community successfully attracts the serious interest of a prospective company only to lose the project, and possibly credibility for future projects, because it fails to offer a competitive site.

It is the opinion of LL+D, based on extensive industrial and commercial site selection experience, that the methodology, objectivity, and level of detail and completeness provided in this report are sufficient to support the competitive claims of the subject site for its intended project land use(s). Accordingly, the information contained in this report can and should be used to supplement site marketing materials, specifically for RFI responses and proactive target industry solicitations. However, EDOs should exercise judicious use of SSI Phase II site information for the purposes of site marketing in advance of formal landowner engagement and security of real estate purchase opinion. The real estate purchase option is pursued during SSI Phase III: Landowner Engagement.

Warranty

All Phase II project tasks are intended to serve as an informed guide to determination of site advancement to the formal due diligence phase of inventory development. All information and opinions provided in this report are limited to planning-level engineering and environmental considerations and do not rise to the investigative level of study for site design uses.

All data used in this study originates from public domain sources. All findings derived from the use of public domain data are subject to potential errors and omissions inherent digital data sets which may include spatial and attribute accuracy, completeness, and currency. Data and other information cited in this study has not been verified for quality of accuracy. As such, the confidence in findings provided herein and corresponding opinions are subject to the limitations of the data and other information sources consulted in the conduct of this study.

Ultimate site development potential and fatal flaw analysis cannot be determined without physically visiting the site and conducting formal engineering and environmental due diligence. However, Leotta Location and Design is confident that our site screening methodology is highly effective in eliminating low quality or practically undevelopable sites and presents candidate sites with a high likelihood of confirming results through more formal engineering and environmental due diligence.

APPENDIX A

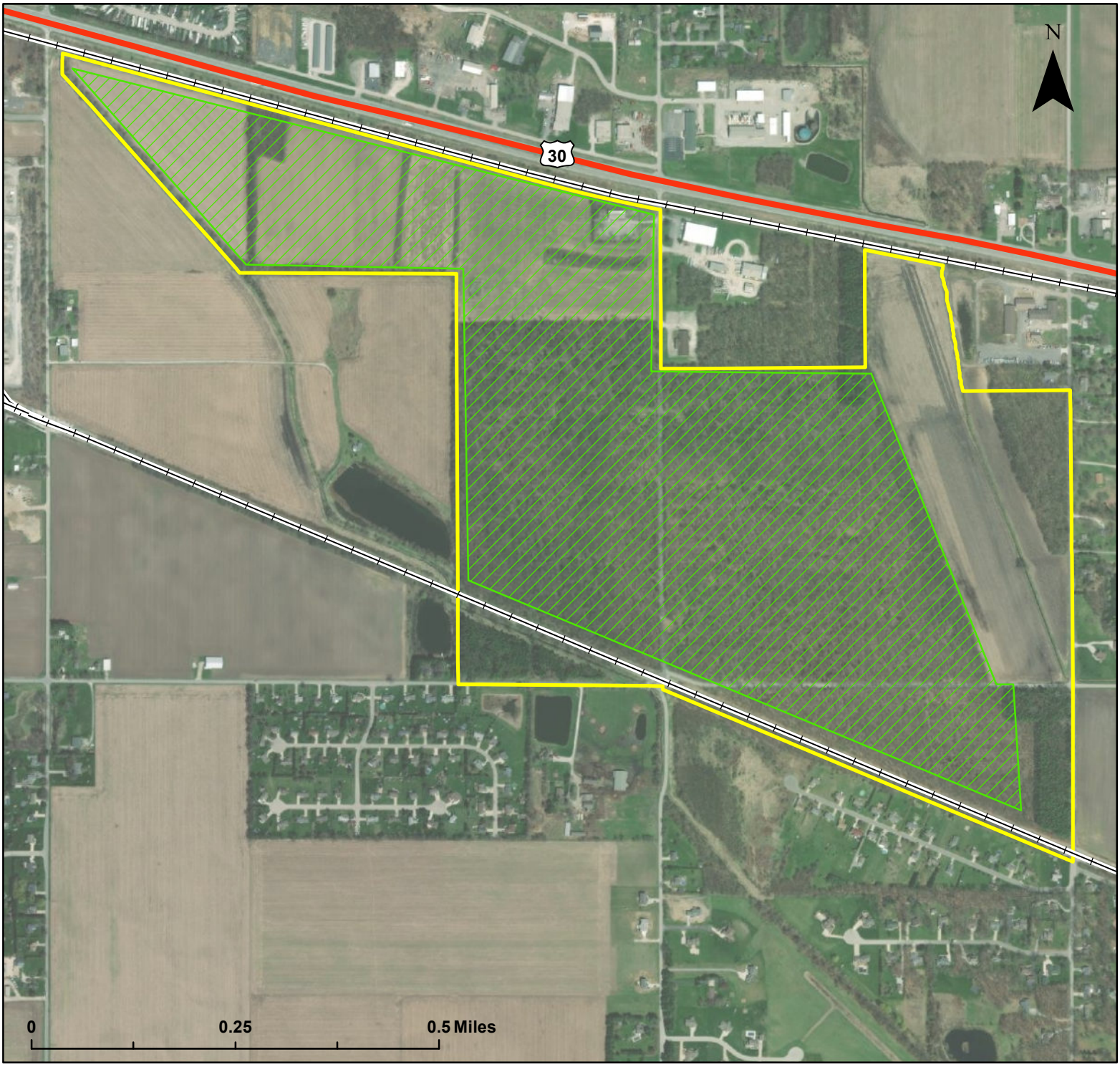
SITE MAPS

SSI Phase II: Preliminary Due Diligence

Porter County, Indiana

Site ID: 18127-020 (312.1 acres)

CITY OF VALPARAISO



Legend

- Rail
- U.S. Highway
- Site Boundary
- Buildable Area

SITE MAP

Site: ~312.1 acres

Buildable Area: ~217.8 acres

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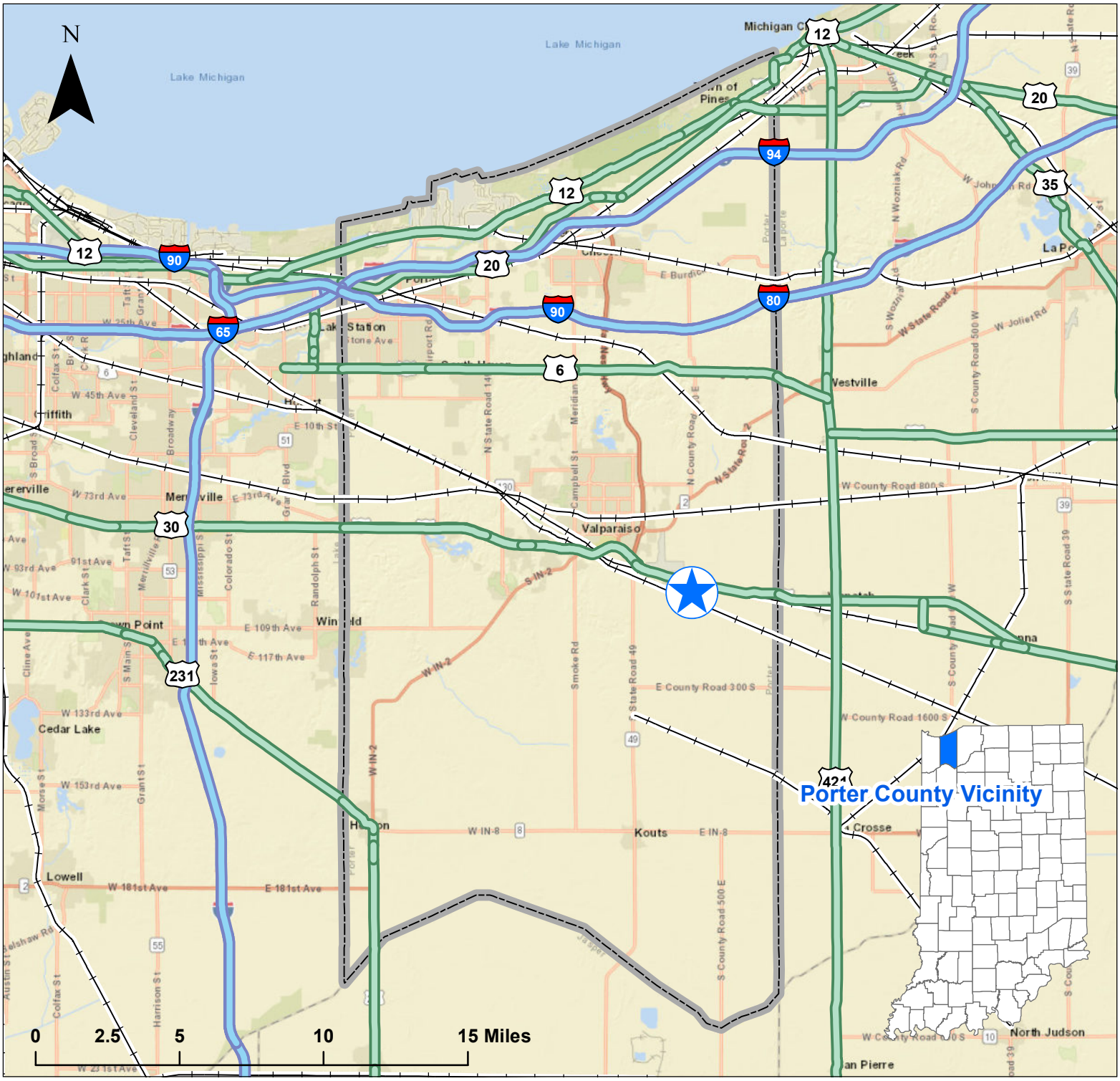
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SSI Phase II: Preliminary Due Diligence

Porter County, Indiana

Site ID: 18127-020 (312.1 acres)

CITY OF VALPARAISO



Legend

- Site Point
- Interstate
- U.S. Highway
- Class I Railroad
- Porter County

SITE VICINITY

Porter County, Indiana

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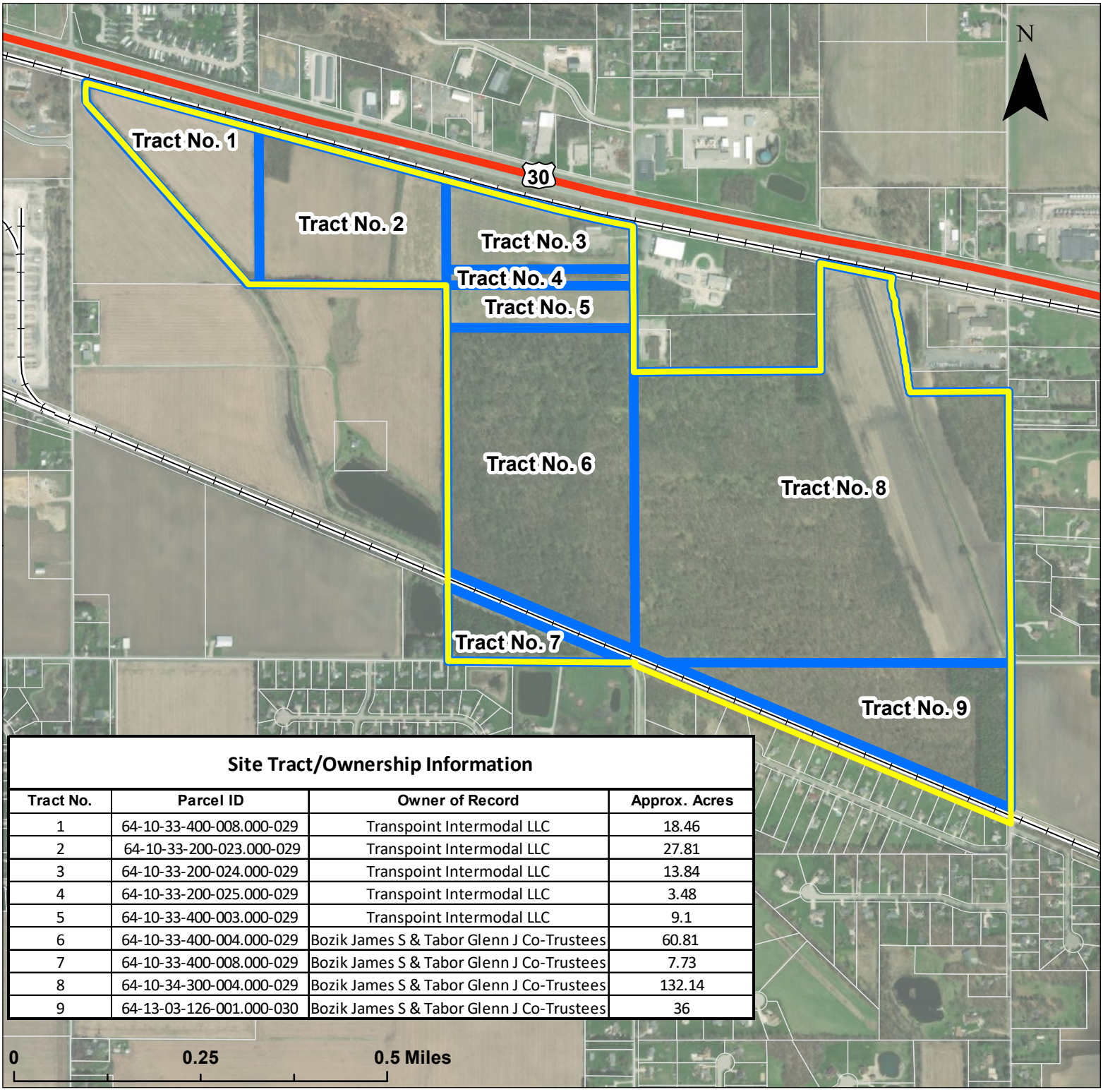
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SSI Phase II: Preliminary Due Diligence

Porter County, Indiana

Site ID: 18127-020 (312.1 acres)

CITY OF VALPARAISO



Site Tract/Ownership Information

Tract No.	Parcel ID	Owner of Record	Approx. Acres
1	64-10-33-400-008.000-029	Transpoint Intermodal LLC	18.46
2	64-10-33-200-023.000-029	Transpoint Intermodal LLC	27.81
3	64-10-33-200-024.000-029	Transpoint Intermodal LLC	13.84
4	64-10-33-200-025.000-029	Transpoint Intermodal LLC	3.48
5	64-10-33-400-003.000-029	Transpoint Intermodal LLC	9.1
6	64-10-33-400-004.000-029	Bozik James S & Tabor Glenn J Co-Trustees	60.81
7	64-10-33-400-008.000-029	Bozik James S & Tabor Glenn J Co-Trustees	7.73
8	64-10-34-300-004.000-029	Bozik James S & Tabor Glenn J Co-Trustees	132.14
9	64-13-03-126-001.000-030	Bozik James S & Tabor Glenn J Co-Trustees	36

Legend

- Rail
- Parcel
- Major Highway
- Site Boundary
- Site Parcel

SITE PARCEL CONFIGURATION

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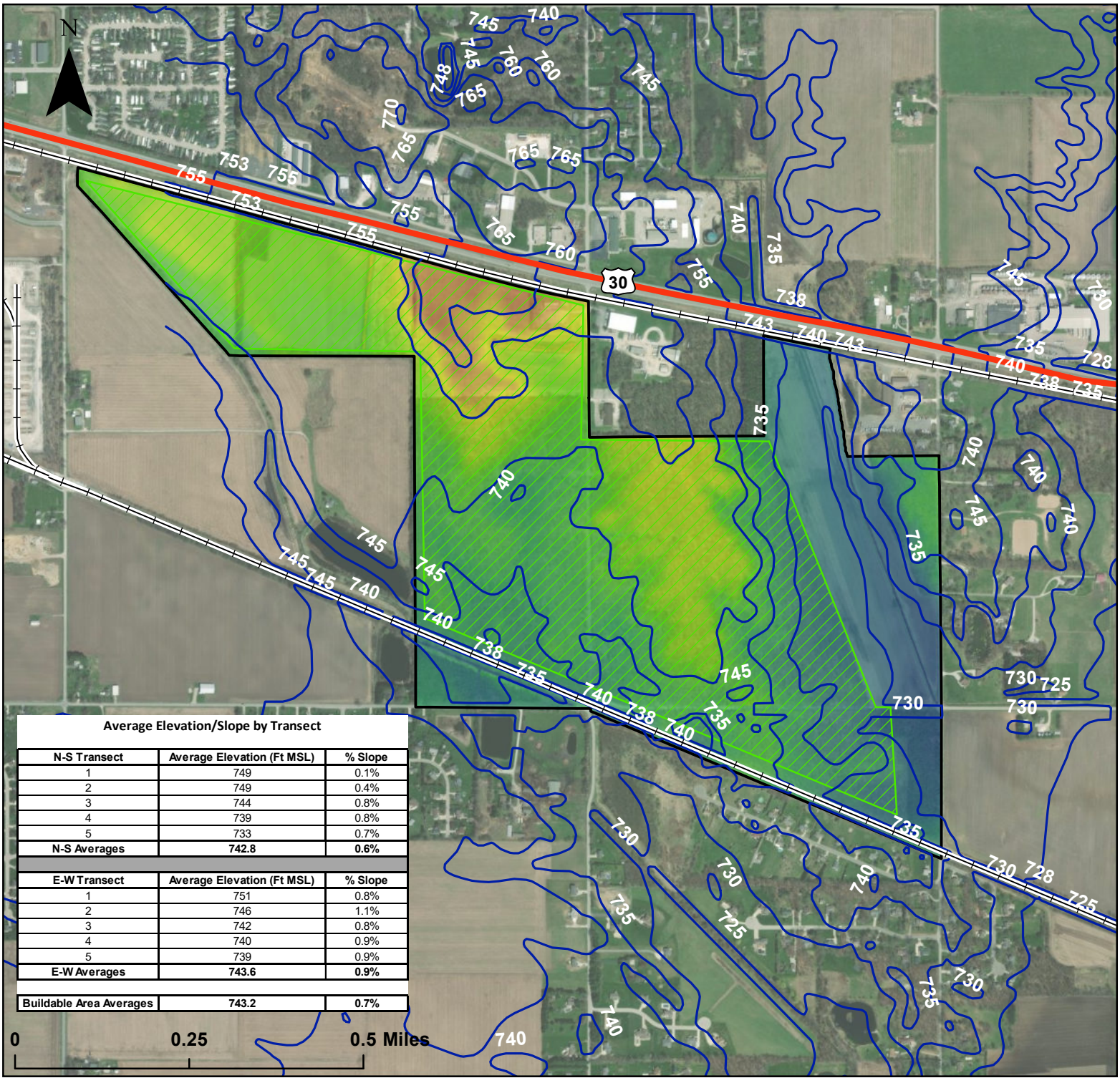
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SSI Phase II: Preliminary Due Diligence

Porter County, Indiana

Site ID: 18127-020 (312.1 acres)

CITY OF VALPARAISO



Average Elevation/Slope by Transect

N-S Transect	Average Elevation (Ft MSL)	% Slope
1	749	0.1%
2	749	0.4%
3	744	0.8%
4	739	0.8%
5	733	0.7%
N-S Averages	**742.8**	**0.6%**

E-W Transect	Average Elevation (Ft MSL)	% Slope
1	751	0.8%
2	746	1.1%
3	742	0.8%
4	740	0.9%
5	739	0.9%
E-W Averages	**743.6**	**0.9%**

Buildable Area Averages	**743.2**	**0.7%**

Legend

- U.S. Highway
- Rail
- Site Boundary
- Buildable Area
- Contours - 10 ft

LiDAR-derived DEM

Value

High : 764'

Low : 723'

BUILDABLE AREA ELEVATION/SLOPE

LiDAR-derived Digital Elevation Model

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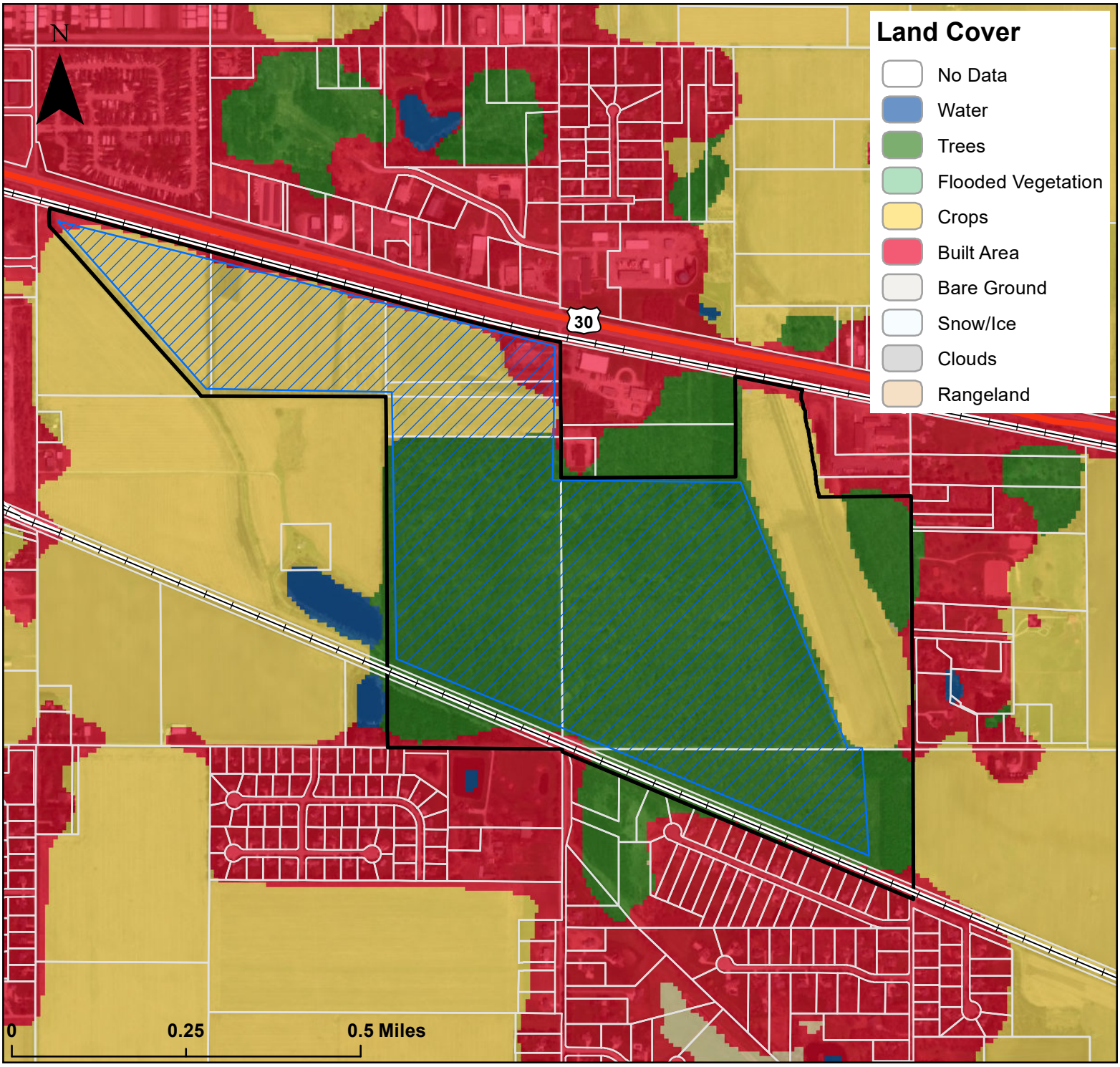
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SSI Phase II: Preliminary Due Diligence

Porter County, Indiana

Site ID: 18127-020 (312.1 acres)

CITY OF VALPARAISO



Legend

- Rail
- U.S. Highway
- Site Boundary
- Buildable Area
- Parcel

LAND COVER CLASSIFICATIONS

Indiana 2017-2021 Land Cover Map

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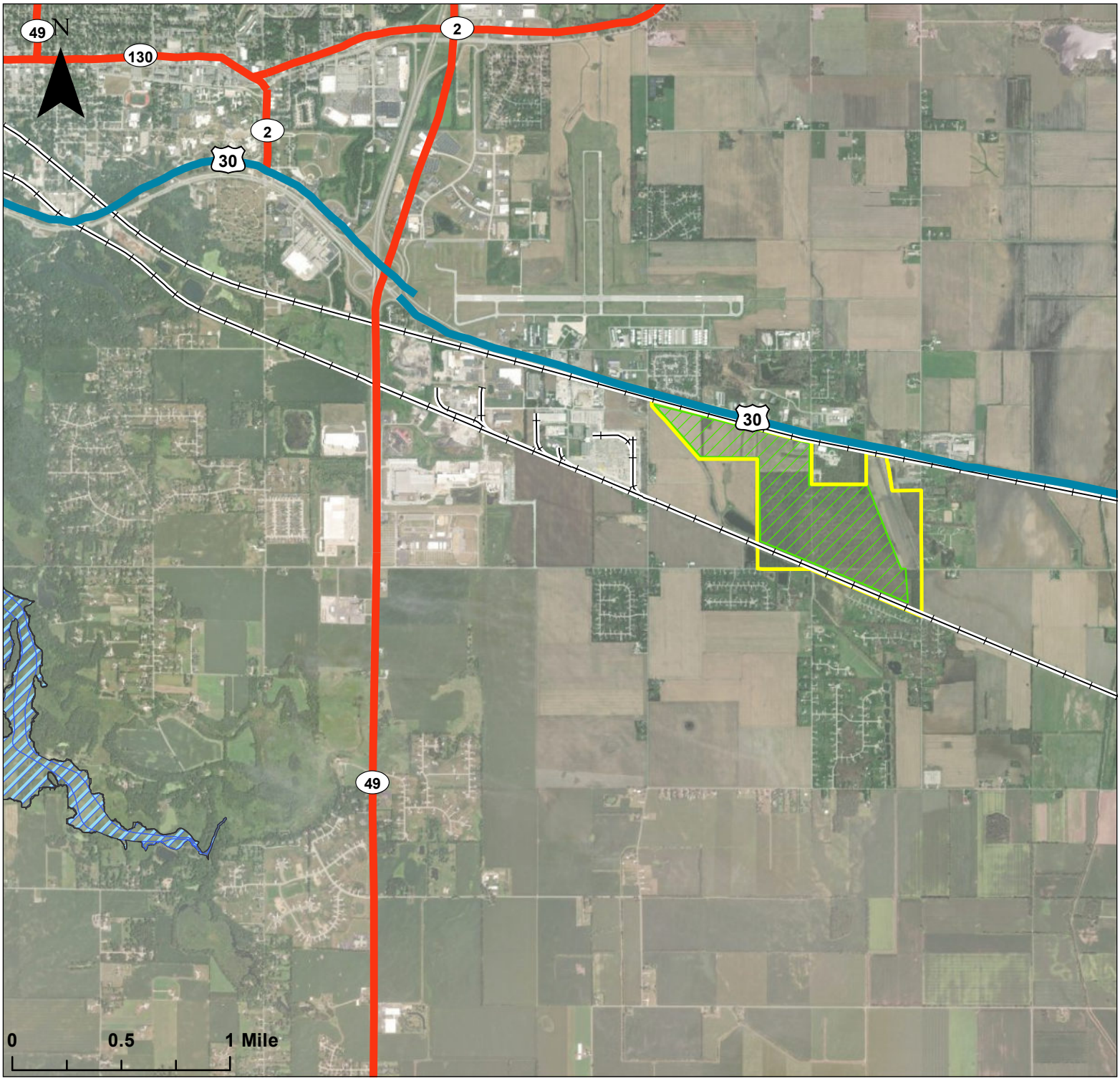
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SSI Phase II: Preliminary Due Diligence

Porter County, Indiana

Site ID: 18127-020 (312.1 acres)

CITY OF VALPARAISO



Legend

- U.S. Highway
- State Highway
- Rail
- Site Boundary
- Buildable Area

Flood Zone

- AE
- X

Potential Flood Hazard

FEMA National Flood Hazard Layer

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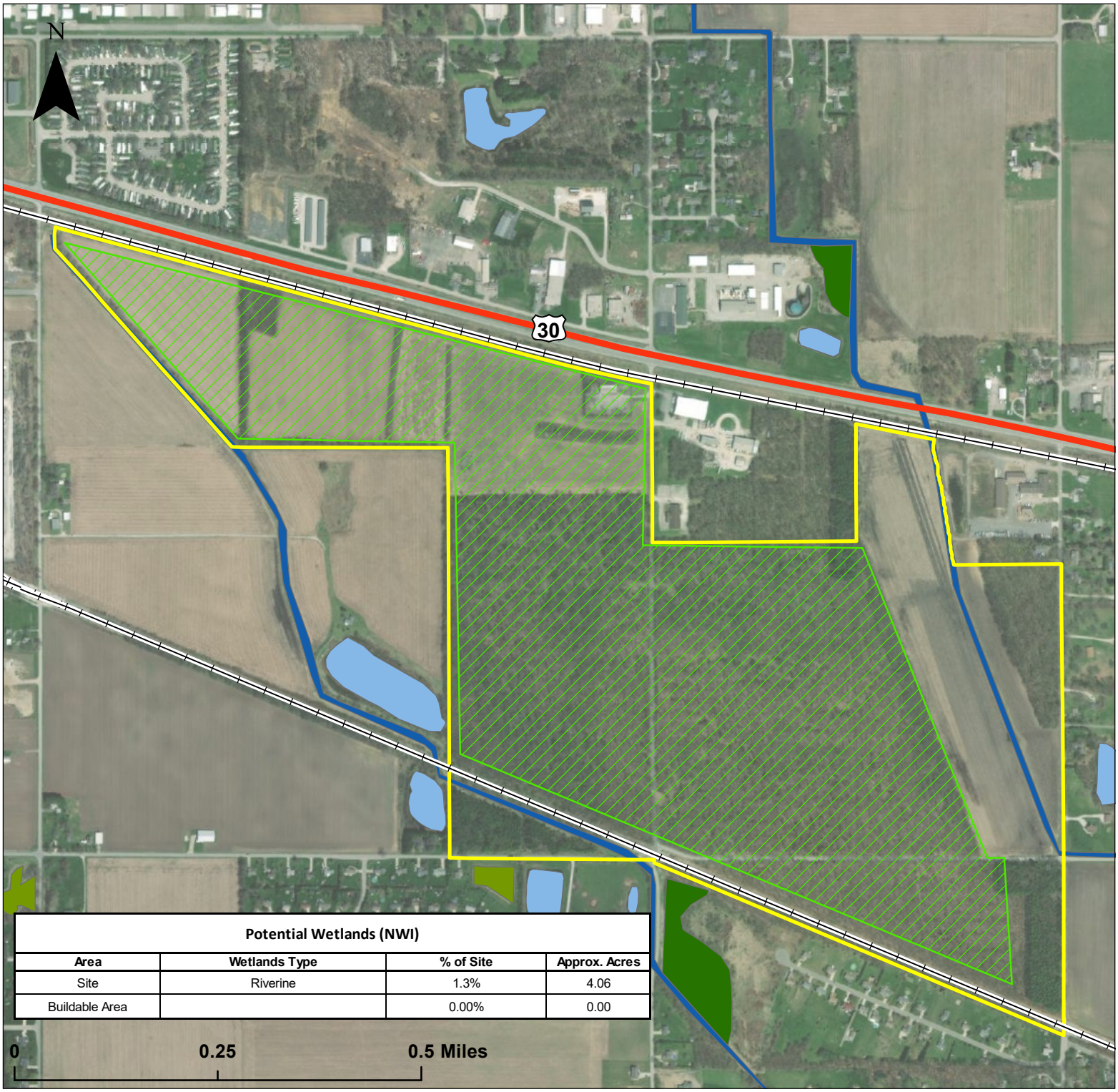
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SSI Phase II: Preliminary Due Diligence

Porter County, Indiana

Site ID: 18127-020 (312.1 acres)

CITY OF VALPARAISO



Potential Wetlands (NWI)			
Area	**Wetlands Type**	**% of Site**	**Approx. Acres**
Site	Riverine	1.3%	4.06
Buildable Area		0.00%	0.00

Legend

- Rail
- Major Highway
- Site Boundary
- Buildable Area

National Wetlands Inventory

Potential Wetland Type

- Freshwater Emergent Wetland
- Freshwater Forested/Shrub Wetland
- Freshwater Pond
- Riverine

Potential Wetlands

USFW/USGS National Wetlands Inventory

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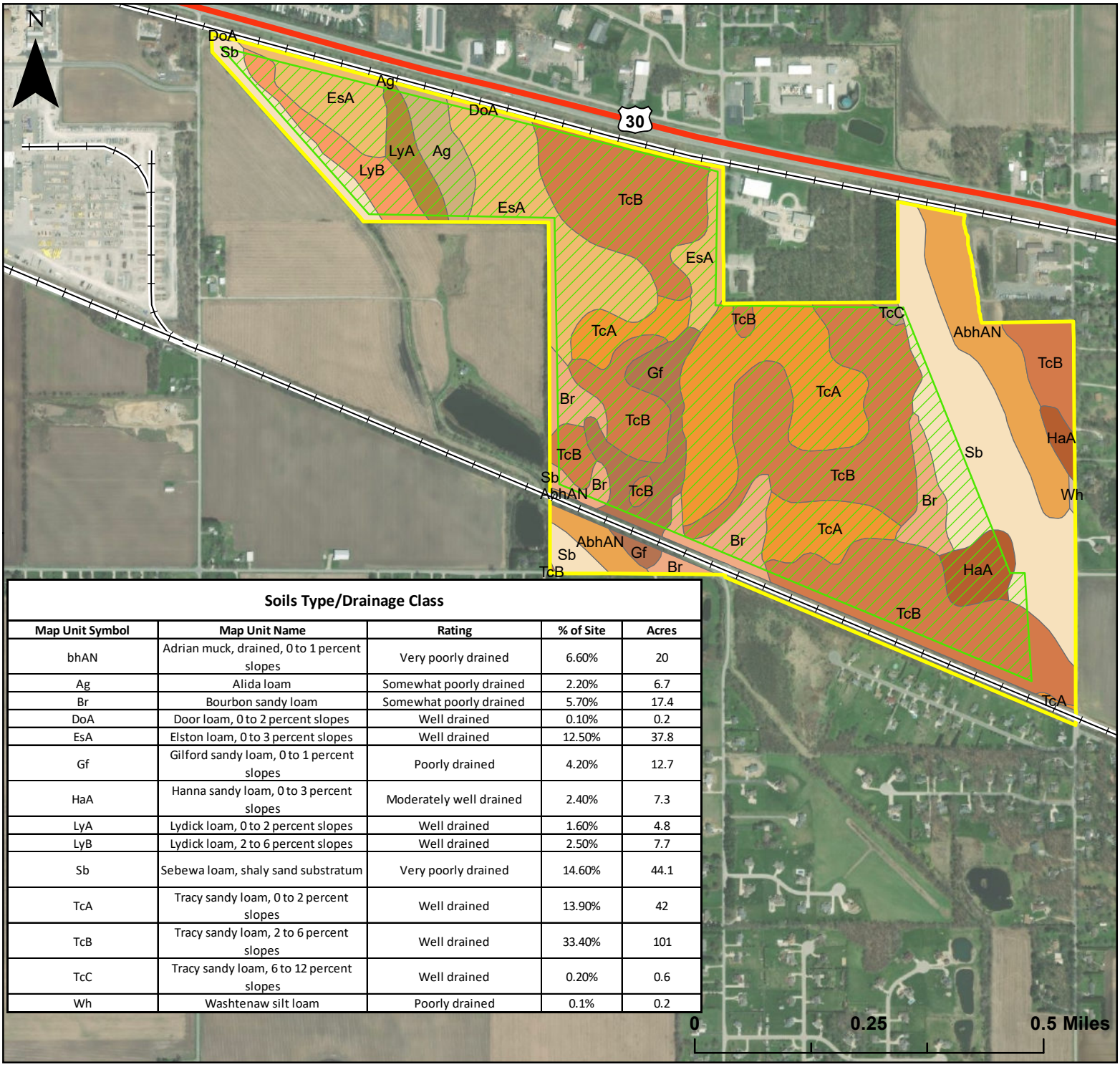
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SSI Phase II: Preliminary Due Diligence

Porter County, Indiana

Site ID: 18127-020 (312.1 acres)

CITY OF VALPARAISO



Soils Type/Drainage Class

Map Unit Symbol	Map Unit Name	Rating	% of Site	Acres
bhAN	Adrian muck, drained, 0 to 1 percent slopes	Very poorly drained	6.60%	20
Ag	Alida loam	Somewhat poorly drained	2.20%	6.7
Br	Bourbon sandy loam	Somewhat poorly drained	5.70%	17.4
DoA	Door loam, 0 to 2 percent slopes	Well drained	0.10%	0.2
EsA	Elston loam, 0 to 3 percent slopes	Well drained	12.50%	37.8
Gf	Gilford sandy loam, 0 to 1 percent slopes	Poorly drained	4.20%	12.7
HaA	Hanna sandy loam, 0 to 3 percent slopes	Moderately well drained	2.40%	7.3
LyA	Lydick loam, 0 to 2 percent slopes	Well drained	1.60%	4.8
LyB	Lydick loam, 2 to 6 percent slopes	Well drained	2.50%	7.7
Sb	Sebewa loam, shaly sand substratum	Very poorly drained	14.60%	44.1
TcA	Tracy sandy loam, 0 to 2 percent slopes	Well drained	13.90%	42
TcB	Tracy sandy loam, 2 to 6 percent slopes	Well drained	33.40%	101
TcC	Tracy sandy loam, 6 to 12 percent slopes	Well drained	0.20%	0.6
Wh	Washtenaw silt loam	Poorly drained	0.1%	0.2

Legend

- Rail
- U.S. Highway
- Site Boundary
- Buildable Area

Soil Type

AbhAN, Ag, Br, DoA, EsA, Gf, HaA, LyA, LyB, Sb, TcA, TcB, TcC, Wh

SSURGO SOILS

Map Unit Name, Percent Slopes

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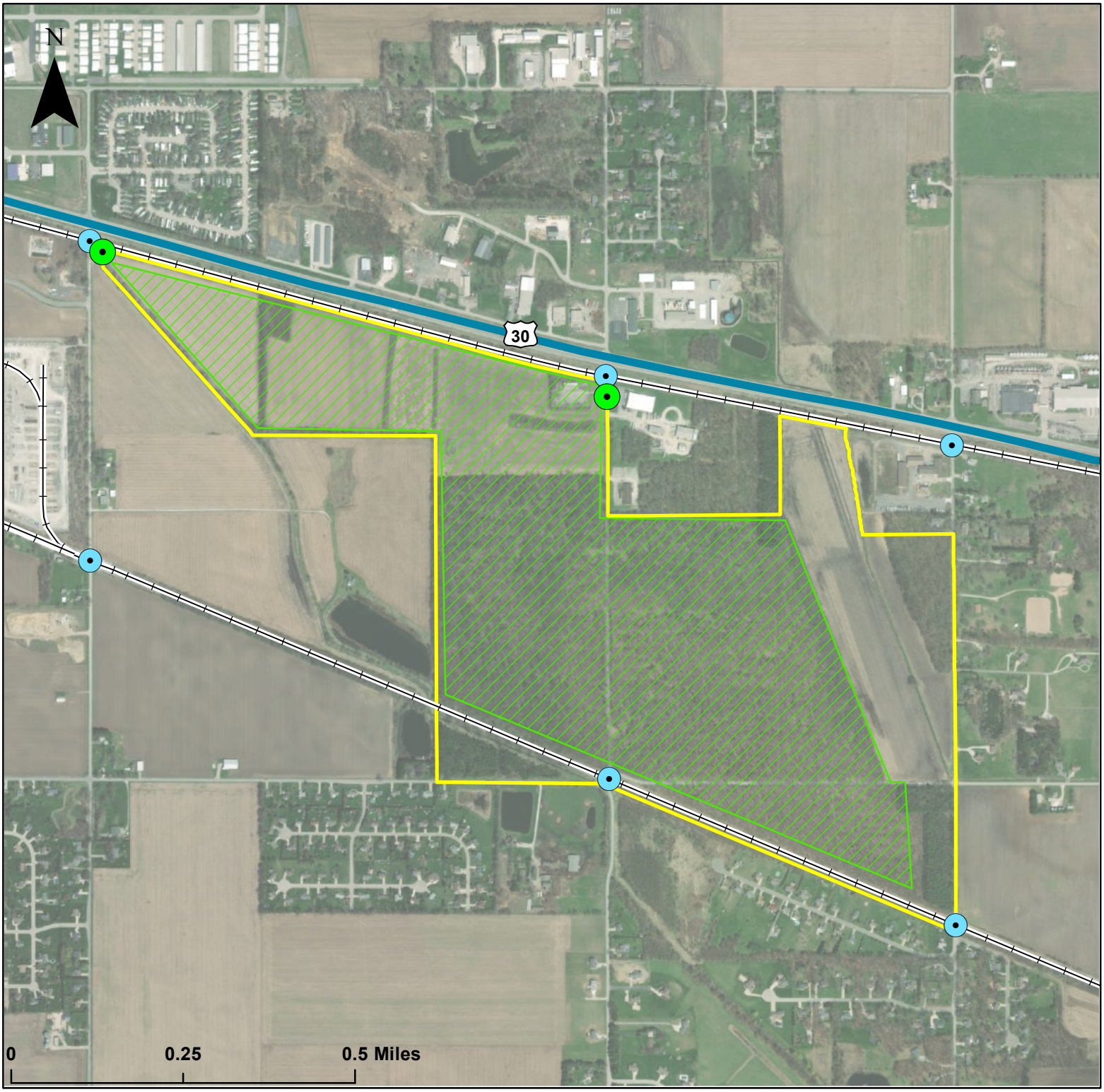
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SSI Phase II: Preliminary Due Diligence

Porter County, Indiana

Site ID: 18127-020 (312.1 acres)

CITY OF VALPARAISO



Legend

- Potential Egress/Ingress Point
- Potential Rail Crossing
- U.S. Highway
- Rail
- Site Boundary
- Buildable Area

SITE TRANSPORTATION FEATURES

with Potential Site Access Points

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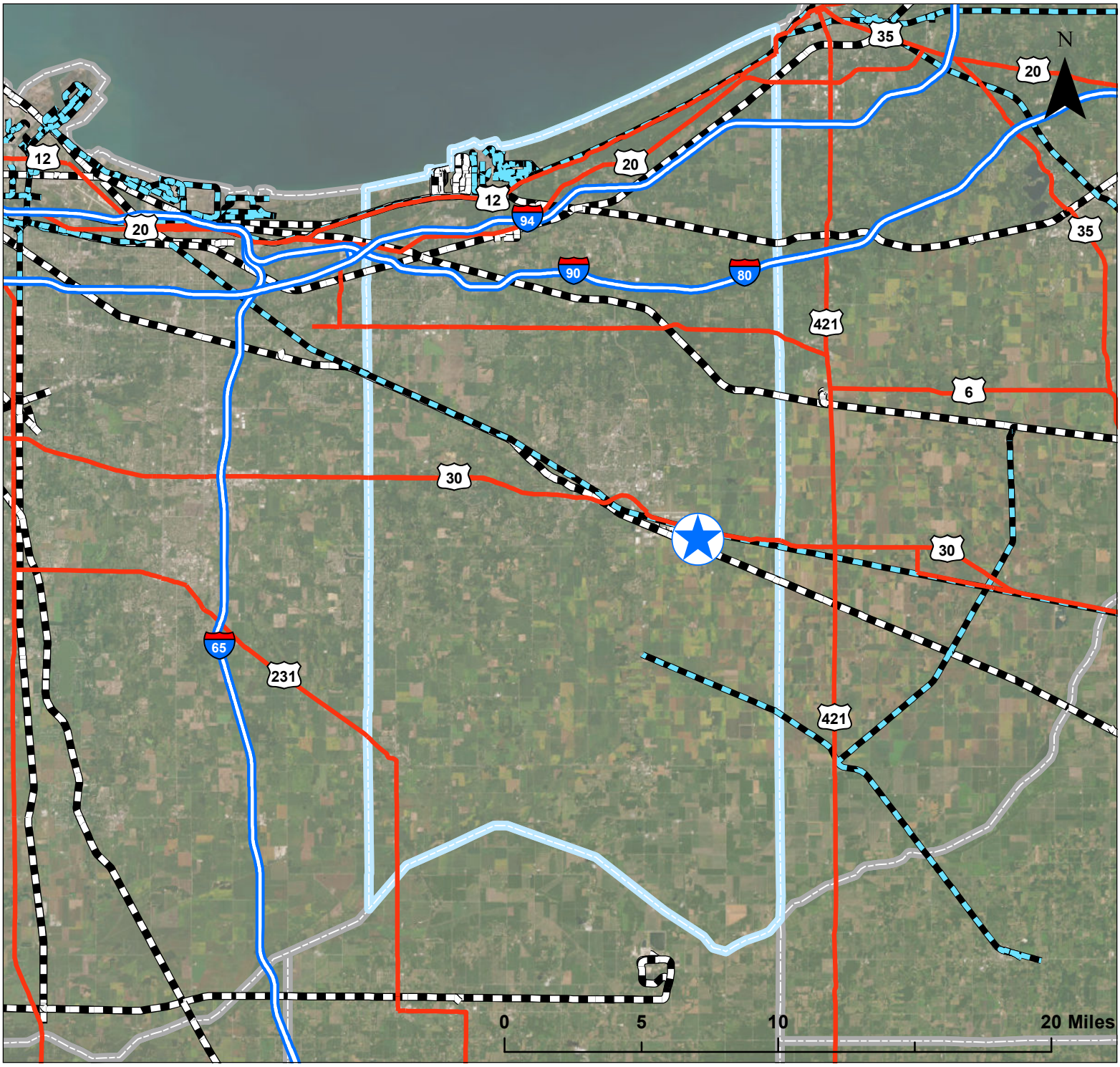
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SSI Phase II: Preliminary Due Diligence

Porter County, Indiana

Site ID: 18127-020 (312.1 acres)

CITY OF VALPARAISO



Legend

- Class I Railroad
- Shortline
- Interstate
- U.S. Highway
- Site Point
- Porter County
- County

SITE PRIMARY TRANSPORTATION ASSETS

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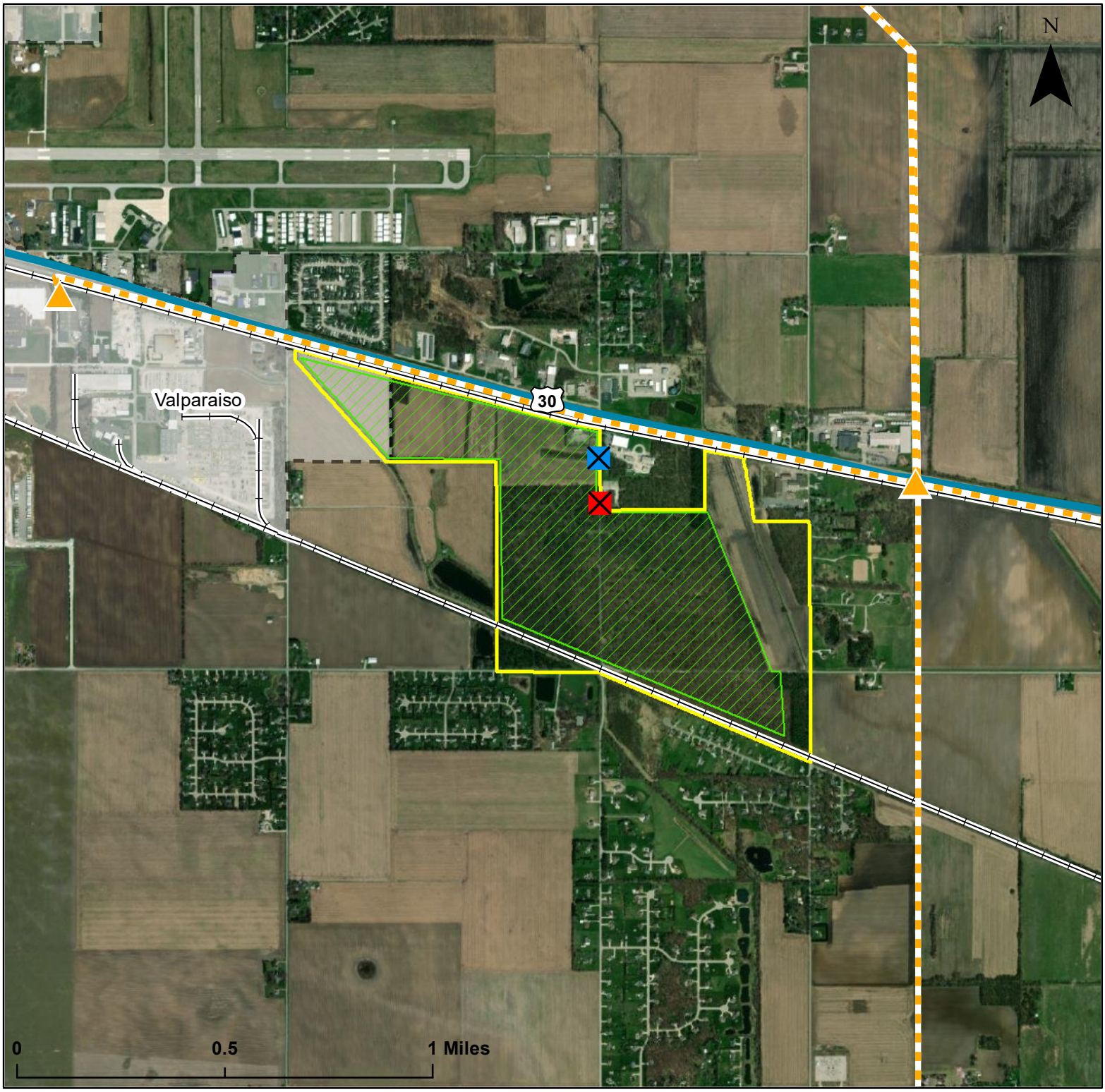
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SSI Phase II: Preliminary Due Diligence

Porter County, Indiana

Site ID: 18127-020 (312.1 acres)

CITY OF VALPARAISO



Legend

Utility Type

- Electric, Gas
- Water, Sewer
- Electric Substation
- Electric Transmission Line
- U.S. Highway
- Rail
- Site Boundary
- Buildable Area
- Municipal Limits

ENERGY INFRASTRUCTURE/UTILITY ACCESS

with Utility Access Point

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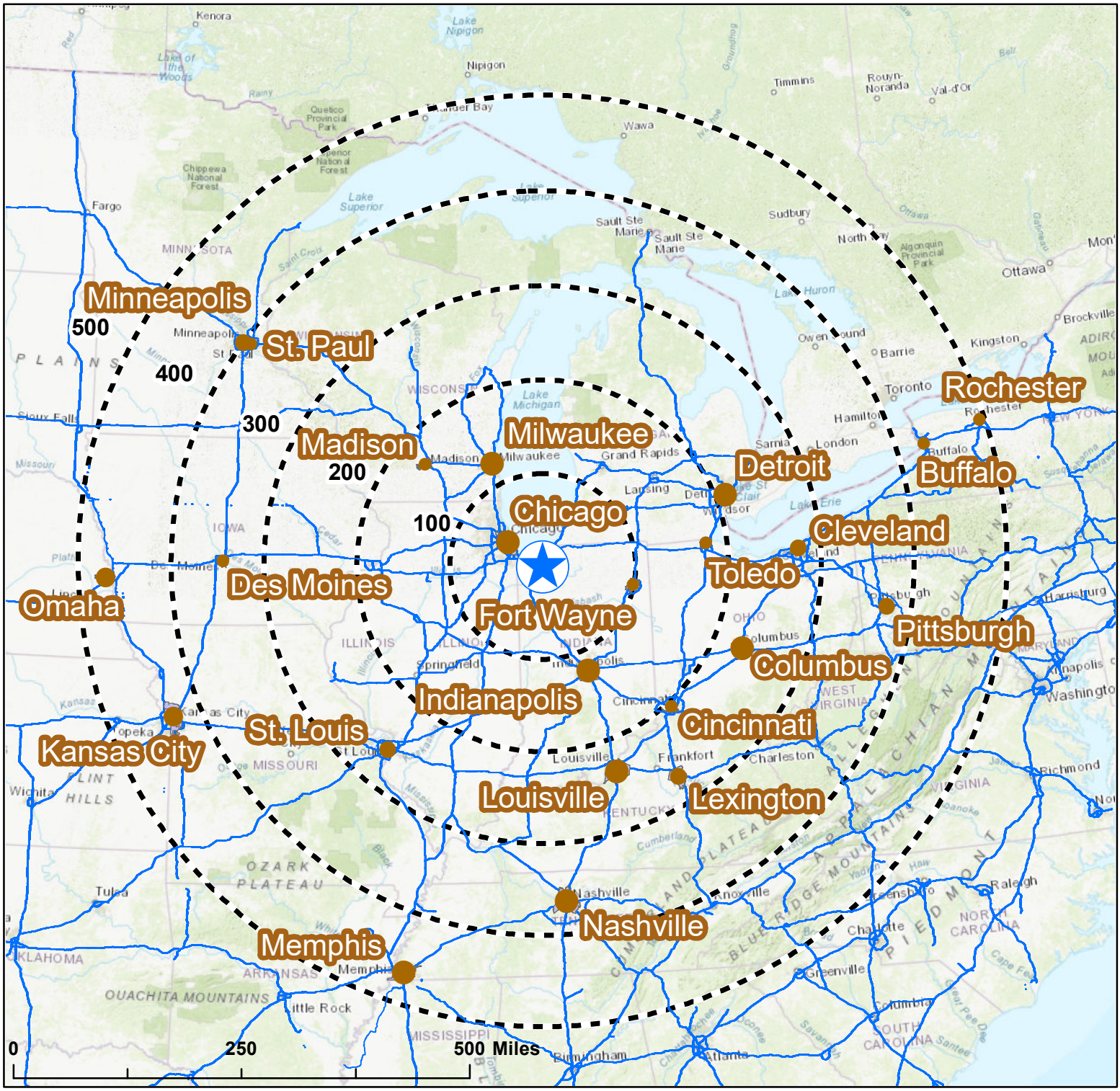
SSI Phase II conducted by: LEOTTA LOCATION + DESIGN

SSI Phase II: Preliminary Due Diligence

Porter County, Indiana

Site ID: 18127-020 (312.1 acres)

CITY OF VALPARAISO



Legend

- Site Point
- Interstate
- Distance in Miles

Major Markets

Population

- <100,000
- 100,000 - 199,999
- 200,000 - 299,999
- 300,000 - 399,999
- 400,000 - 499,999
- >500,000

TRAVEL DISTANCE

Major Markets

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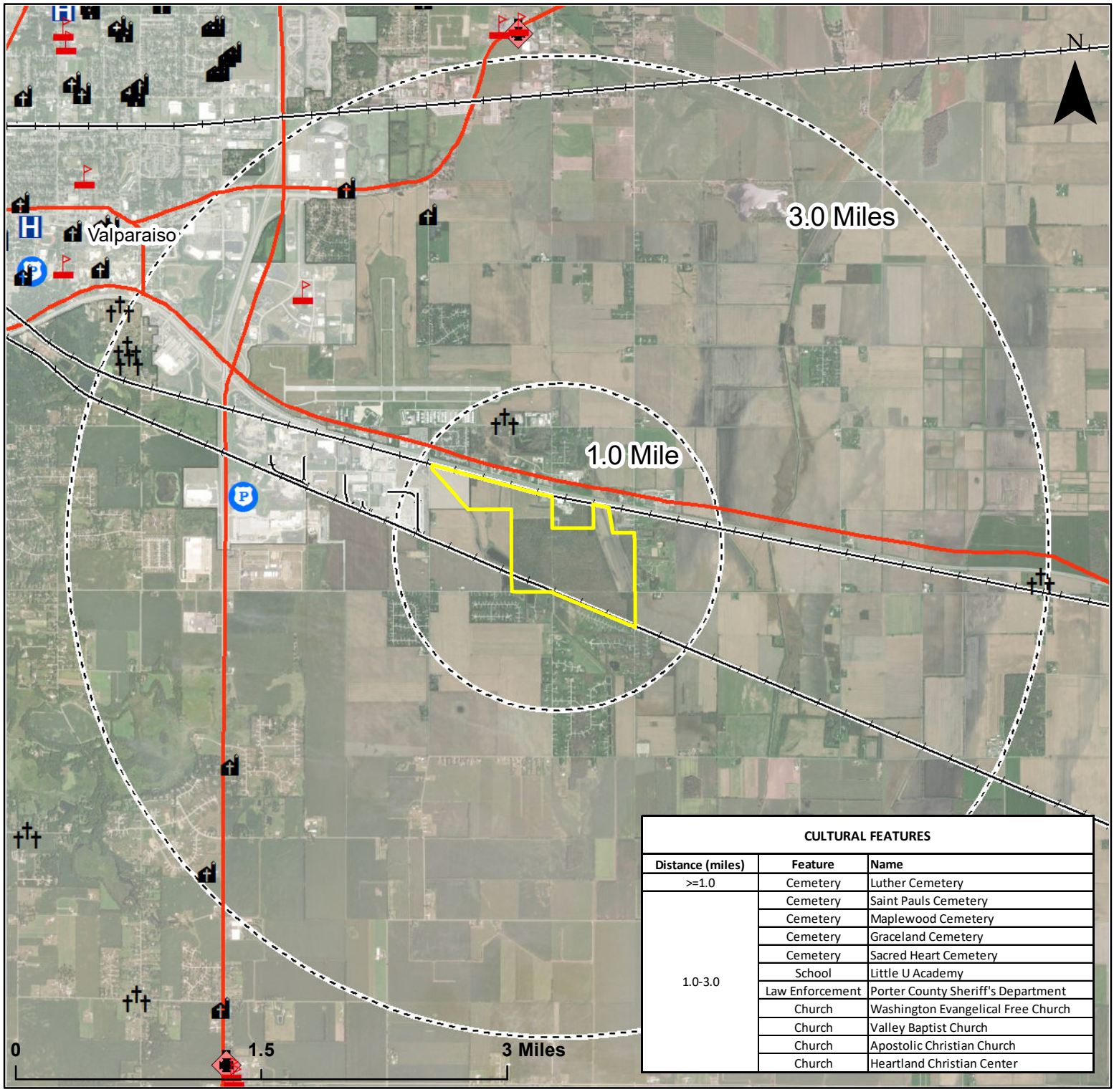
SSI Phase II conducted by: LEOTTA LOCATION + DESIGN

SSI Phase II: Preliminary Due Diligence

Porter County, Indiana

Site ID: 18127-020 (312.1 acres)

CITY OF VALPARAISO



CULTURAL FEATURES

Distance (miles)	Feature	Name
>=1.0	Cemetery	Luther Cemetery
1.0-3.0	Cemetery	Saint Pauls Cemetery
	Cemetery	Maplewood Cemetery
	Cemetery	Graceland Cemetery
	Cemetery	Sacred Heart Cemetery
	School	Little U Academy
	Law Enforcement	Porter County Sheriff's Department
	Church	Washington Evangelical Free Church
	Church	Valley Baptist Church
	Church	Apostolic Christian Church
	Church	Heartland Christian Center

Legend

- Site Boundary
- Rail
- Highway
- Distance in miles
- Municipal Limits
- Police Station
- Fire Rescue/EMS
- Hospital
- School
- Cemetery
- Church

CULTURAL FEATURES

within 1.0 and 3.0 Miles of Site

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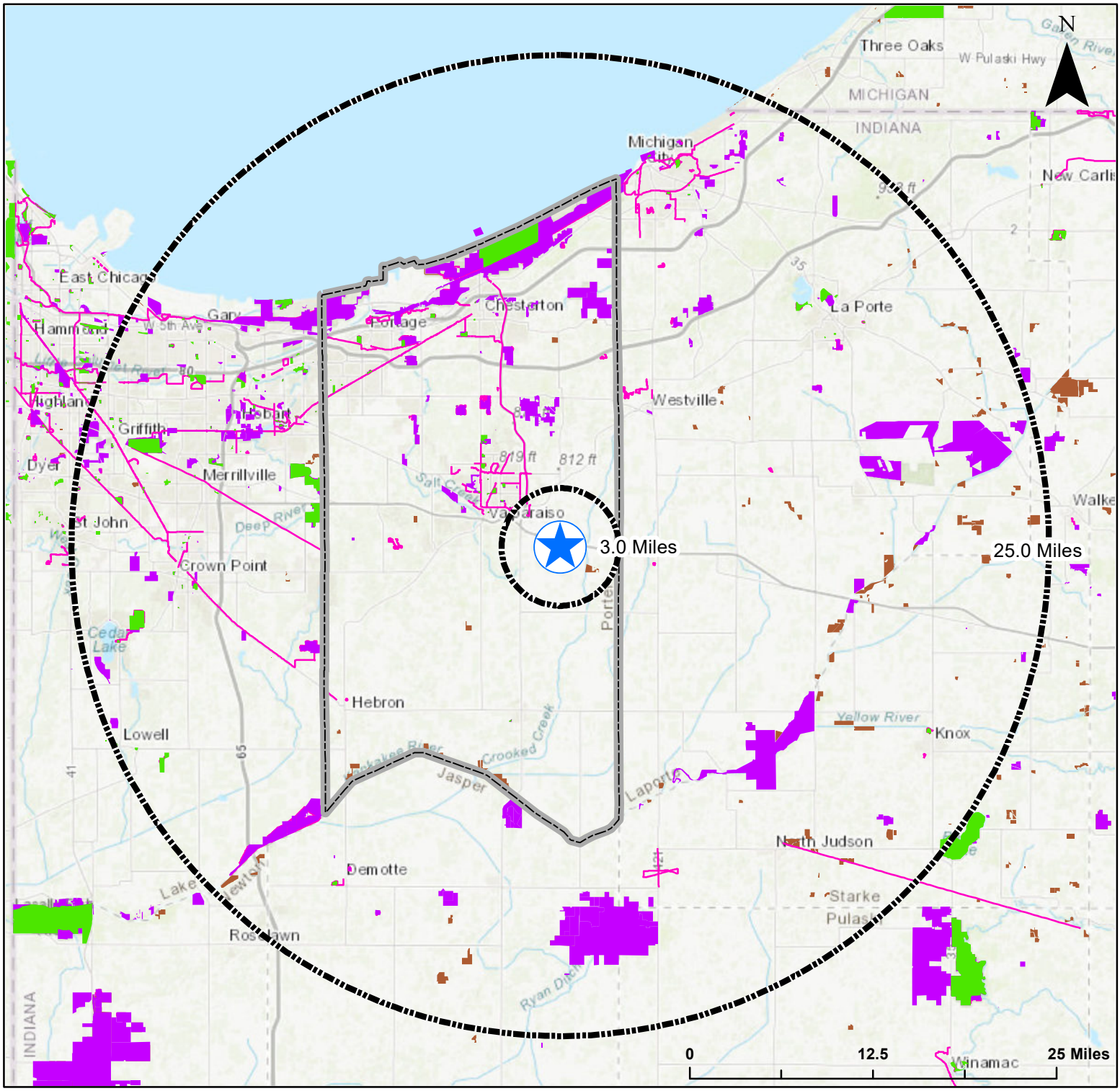
SSI Phase II conducted by: LEOTTA LOCATION + DESIGN

SSI Phase II: Preliminary Due Diligence

Porter County, Indiana

Site ID: 18127-020 (312.1 acres)

CITY OF VALPARAISO



Legend

- Site Point
- IDNR Trails
- Porter County
- Local/State Parks
- National Forests
- INDR Managed Lands
- Conservation Easements
- Distance In Miles

FEDERAL, STATE, AND LOCAL PARKS AND PROTECTED AREAS

within 3.0 and 25.0 Miles of Site

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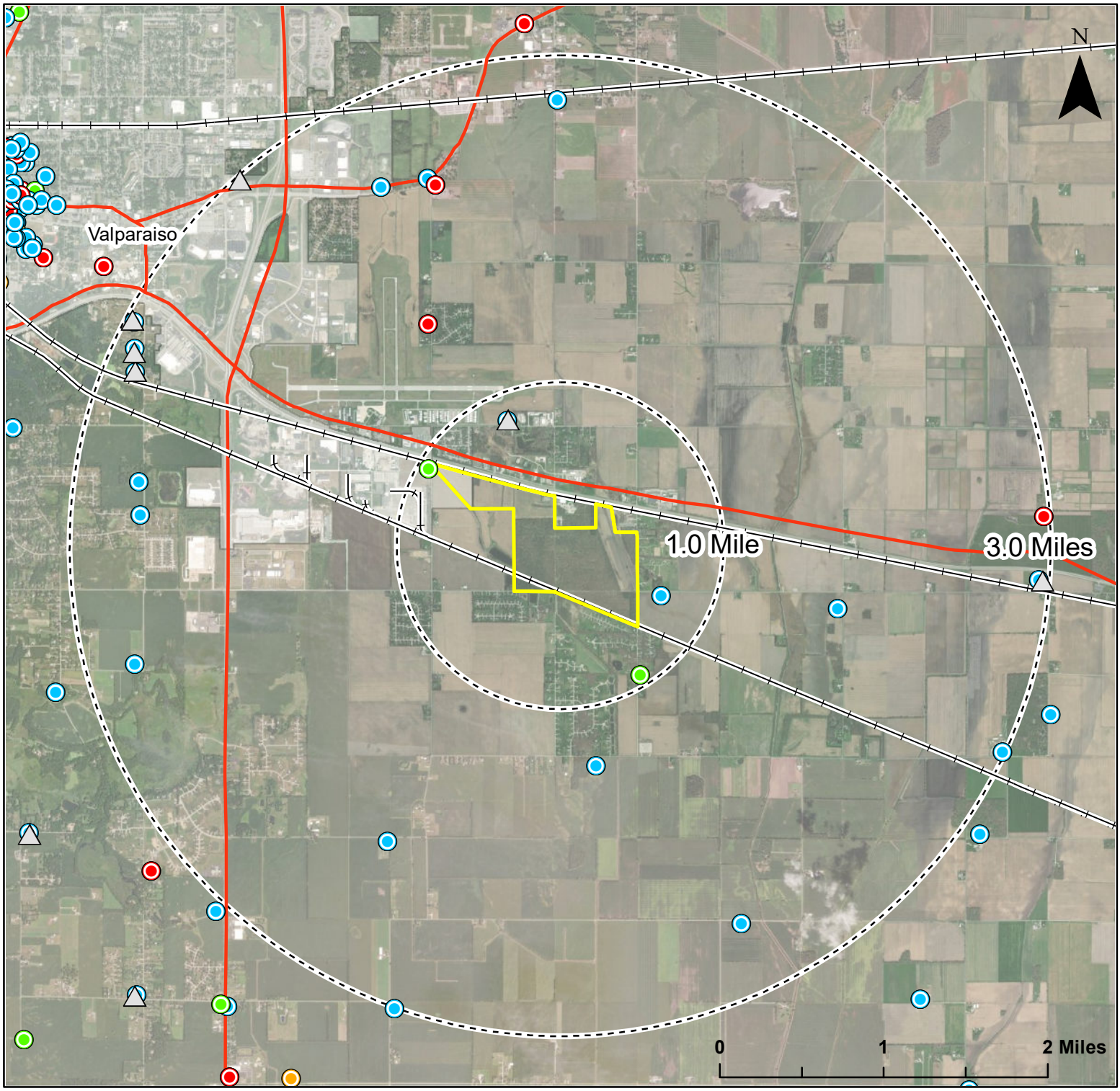
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SSI Phase II: Preliminary Due Diligence

Porter County, Indiana

Site ID: 18127-020 (312.1 acres)

CITY OF VALPARAISO



Historic Sites and Structures

- Demolished
- Non-Contributing
- Contributing
- Notable
- Outstanding

- Historic Bridge
- Cemetery
- Rail
- Highway
- Site Boundary
- Distance in miles

HISTORIC RESOURCES

within 1.0 and 3.0 Miles of Site

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